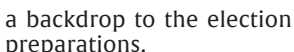


PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

According to the notification, the last date for receipt of nomination papers along with a demand draft of Rs 500 and affidavits is September 10 till 3 pm.

The university had earlier appointed Raj Kishore Sharma from the Department of Chemistry as the chief election officer and librarian Rajesh Singh as the chief returning officer for

The announcement has given student groups a formal timeline to turn their recent campus mobilisation into election campaigns, with organisations expected to intensify outreach across colleges in the coming weeks. The recent protests at Jantar Mantar, which centred on issues concerning the National Testing Agency (NTA), admissions and access to education, have provided



The DUSU polls are among the country's most closely watched student elections and traditionally witness intense contests between the RSS-affiliated Akhil Bharatiya Vidyarthi Parishad

(ABVP), Congress-backed National Students' Union of India (NSUI), Students' Federation of India (SFI) and All India Students' Association (AISA). The upcoming polls will be closely watched against the backdrop of last year's

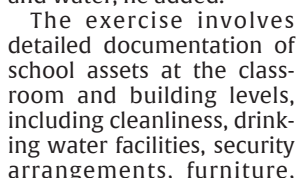
The DUSU polls are not just the largest stage for student politics in India. It has long been regarded as a “nursery” for national politics and a battleground for shaping perception. Winning here is

In last year's DUSU elections, BJP-backed ABVP clinched three posts, while Congress's NSUI won one post. ABVP's Aryan Mann won the President post,

Following his stint in student politics, Gajraj entered into mainstream politics, he won the assembly election from the Mewla Maharajpur constituency of Faridabad in 1977. He later became the Minister of Food and Supplies in the Haryana Cabinet. DUSU's first president died at the age of 73 in 2001.

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

The move follows a city-wide digital profiling exercise covering all 1,090 govern-

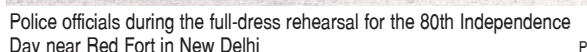


Based on the scientific assessment, school buildings will be categorised for retention, repair, retrofitting or demolition to ensure the safety of students and staff, the official said.

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

In East Delhi, police have been conducting intensive

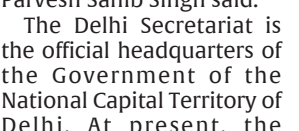
inations, tactical positioning, team coordination and rapid response for the effective



Police said personnel from Mukherji Nagar police station intercepted a suspicious car

An automatic pistol and 10 live cartridges were alleged-

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi



The Income Tax Office will be moved to a redeveloped multi-storey building on the opposite side from where it is currently, Singh said. According to the plan, the Government will redevelop a total of 18 acres of land, out of this five acres of land belong to the Income Tax Office, which will get space in a newly built office

Faced with the space crunch, the Delhi government has decided to build a new Delhi Secretariat at Indraprastha Estate, where the MSO building and Vikas Bhawan, north and south of Vikas Marg, would be redeveloped. Conceived several years ago, the project is moving to a preliminary stage.

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

According to the Authority, this project is one of four special licence projects DDA has auctioned over the past year and marks the first instance in which DDA has formally executed such a licensing agreement. The site will soon be handed over to Juniper Hotels Ltd, and the hotel is scheduled to become operational by 2030. Over the 55-year

It intends to develop and operate the proposed 5-Star hotel in partnership with Hyatt under the Grand Hyatt brand. Recently, Lieutenant Governor Taranjit Singh Sandhu chaired an interactive session with industry representatives to discuss measures for accelerating Dwarka's growth as a major economic and commercial hub.

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

It alleged that despite the

It has called for examination of CCTV footage, beat registers, duty charts, and medical records as part of the inquiry.



IN FOCUS



People take part in a Tiranga Yatra rally under the Har Ghar Tiranga campaign ahead of Independence Day celebrations at Karad in Satara district, Maharashtra on Thursday

PTI

Har Ghar Tiranga rally held at east Delhi DM office

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

On the occasion of the 80th Independence Day of India, a grand "Har Ghar Tiranga" Rally was organised at the District Magistrate (DM) Office, East District, in collaboration with the District Magistrate Office, East District, and the Department of Women and Child Development (WCD), East District.

The rally was led by District Magistrate, East District, Karanjit Vadodaria, along with the ADM, SDM and Tehsildar, Sadhana Singh, District Officer, WCD, East District. Senior officers and officials actively participated in the rally and con-

veyed the message of patriotism, national unity and respect for the Tricolour. The Mission Shakti Team also participated enthusiastically in the rally and contributed to spreading the message of women's empowerment, social responsibility and national pride.

The rally witnessed active participation from CDPOs and supervisors of East District, who joined the programme with great enthusiasm. Selected Anganwadi Workers (AWWs) from different ICDS projects of East District also became part of this grand rally and participated with the spirit of patriotism and unity.



Monsoon Session ends in blame game

"So, nothing has changed in 11 years. There were laws made and now reels are being made but nothing has changed," Ramesh said.

Addressing a press conference after both Houses of Parliament adjourned sine die, Rijiju said the Government was not happy as elaborate discussions on key Bills could not take place. Productivity in Lok Sabha was merely 19 per cent, and in Rajya Sabha 39 per cent, he said.

While Lok Sabha Speaker Om Birla did not read out the usual valedictory address in which he highlights the performance and productivity of the House, Rajya Sabha Chairman CP Radhakrishnan expressed "deep concern" over disruptions that "derailed" the business of the Upper House during the session.

Rijiju said 12 Bills were passed during the Monsoon Session, but sadly only one saw discussions in both Houses, referring to the Public Examination (Prevention of Unfair Means) Amendment Bill, 2026, which was passed by both Houses with voice votes.

The Monsoon Session, which started on July 20, saw prolonged disruptions in both Houses. The Opposition protests initially started over the NEET paper leak and the alleged embezzlement of donations at the Ram temple in Ayodhya. It later pressed for a discussion on the police action against students protesting over the NEET paper leak and demanded the presence and statements of PM Modi and home minister Shah in the House.

To break the logjam, the Government on Monday offered a debate on the paper leak issue and a reply by Shah, but the Congress rejected it. A similar attempt was made on Wednesday too, but that failed as the principal opposition party turned down the proposal again, with Leader of Opposition Rahul Gandhi asserting that the youth want to know who ordered the use of pellet guns on the protesting students.

Meanwhile, the Congress, the Trinamool Congress, and the Samajwadi Party boycotted the customary tea party hosted by Birla after the House was adjourned sine die. Only DMK leader Kanimozhi attended the traditional get-together. In Rajya Sabha, however, opposition leaders, including Congress president Mallikarjun Kharge and former party chief Sonia Gandhi, attended the tea party hosted by the chairman. Prime Minister Narendra Modi, Defence Minister Rajnath Singh, and several other senior leaders and ministers were present at the tea party in the Speaker's chamber.

Badal injured in Nanded attack

Maharashtra Police are investigating the incident since it happened in their state. Kler also said authorities will look into whether a larger conspiracy was involved.

Seva Teerth takes centre stage in I-Day invites

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE ■ New Delhi

The invitation cards for the 80th Independence Day celebrations at the Red Fort prominently depict the newly built Seva Teerth complex, which houses the Prime Minister's Office (PMO), the National Security Council Secretariat and the Cabinet Secretariat.

A 'Dharm Chakra', symbolising the "eternal movement of righteous duty and continuous selfless action", has also been portrayed on the invitation cards. Prime Minister Narendra Modi will lead the celebrations from the Red Fort complex in Delhi on August 15.

"The grand event will also commemorate 150 years of the enduring legacy of the national song 'Vande Mataram' and celebrate the energy, aspirations and pivotal contribution of 'Yuva Shakti' in driving India's journey towards Viksit Bharat by 2047," the Defence Ministry said on Thursday.

The multi-page e-invitation cards issued by the Defence Ministry carry a silhouetted image of the Seva Teerth complex at its centre, an icon of the 'Dharm Chakra' on the top right corner, and name of the enclosure on the top left corner, the list of fundamental duties (in English and Hindi), and the full six stanzas of 'Vande Mataram' (in English and Hindi).



Another page carries a set of three QR codes – one which can be scanned for watching live streaming of the 80th Independence Day celebrations, another one which can be scanned to listen to 'Vande Mataram' and while a third one on scanning will provide the route map, seating arrangement and traffic orientation to reach the venue.

The defence ministry also said, in keeping with its efforts to "end VIP culture" and underscore the importance of water conservation, seating enclosures along the Kartavya Path here, during the 2026 Republic Day celebrations, were named after rivers.

For the 80th Independence Day celebrations, the names of the seating enclosures have been named

after major lakes of India. These include Badkhal, Bhimtal, Chandratat, Chilika, Dalpat Sagar, Dimna, Dudhsagar, Haflong, Harike, Hussain Sagar, Kanwar, Kankaria, Kolleru, Loktak, Lonar, Pangong Tso, Pulicat, Pushkar, Rabindra Sarobar, Ramgarh Tal, Rudrasagar, Sakhya Sagar, Shanti Sagar, Vembanad and Wular, it said.

The new complex houses the PMO, the National Security Council Secretariat and the Cabinet Secretariat. PM had also unveiled the plaque of Seva Teerth at the new complex – the name inscribed in Devanagari script on the wall of the complex. Below it is the motto 'Nagrik Devo Bhava' (citizen is akin to God).

AI group plans to induct over 100 planes in 2 years: CEO

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

Air India is facing challenges due to external volatility but remains focused on the profitability path and plans to induct over 100 new planes over the next two years, its CEO Campbell Wilson said on Thursday.

The loss-making airline has been facing multiple headwinds, and a leadership transition is happening, with former Ethiopian Airlines Group chief Tewolde Gebremariam set to take over as the CEO and MD from Wilson. During a town hall with staff, Wilson, who is likely to



CEO Campbell Wilson

leave the airline next month, said the annual salary increments will come into effect from October 1.

The recently revised pay structure for pilots will also be effective on the

same date, according to sources. Earlier this year, the increment cycle was deferred by one quarter amid the West Asia turmoil significantly impacting flight operations and costs.

3 feared trapped, 16 rescued as water, debris enter tunnel in Uttarakhand's Chamoli

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ Panchalinalga (Andhra Pradesh)

At least three workers were feared trapped and 16 rescued on Thursday after water and debris entered a tunnel under construction at a hydroelectric project site in Chamoli district of Uttarakhand, officials said.

Some of those rescued sustained minor injuries in the incident that occurred at the Tehri Hydro Development Corporation (THDC) Limited's project site in the Pipalkoti area. The construction work is being carried out by the Hindustan Construction Company (HCC), the officials said.

Chief Minister Pushkar Singh Dhami said the government's



People gather outside tunnel of the Vishnugad-Pipalkoti Hydroelectric Project in Chamoli district, Uttarakhand on Thursday

PTI

top priority is to safely rescue everyone trapped.

According to information released by the state government, 18 to 19 workers were trapped inside the tunnel around 7 pm. So far, 16 of them have been safely rescued and the operation to bring out the

remaining workers is underway.

Uttarakhand Chief Secretary Anand Vardhan told PTI that reports were received that several workers were trapped after water and debris entered the tunnel of the Pipalkoti hydroelectric project.

FROM PAGE - 1

Ex-Pakistan minister praises Hafiz Saeed

He also claimed that Saeed's phone number appeared on his mobile during a US visit, which led to his expulsion, adding, "We are with Pakistan, with Hafiz Saeed." He also said, "No birds will chirp in India, nor will bells ring in a temple." Variations in reports include vows to "crush and obliterate" the country.

"When a former minister openly calls himself a slave to a mass murderer and stands with his commanders, it shows where the state's priorities really lie. The video reveals a political culture that supports terror while acting like a victim", intelligence sources said.

Saeed was declared a global terrorist by the United Nations Security Council (UNSC) in December 2010. He is the founder of LeT and Jamaat-ud-Dawa, even though Pakistan sometimes claims to act against him. The open presence of Sandhu and Yaqoob shows that these groups still have political support.

Rasheed's former role as Interior Minister, in charge of internal security, makes this situation even more serious. When a former top official openly supports the leader of cross-border terrorism, it shows how weak Islamabad's denials are to organisations like the Financial Action Task Force (FATF), the United Nations (UN), and Western Governments.

Fresh clash at Assam-Arunachal Pradesh...

The organisations are demanding an early resolution of the Assam-Arunachal Pradesh border dispute, action against miscreants who had fired two days ago and an end to alleged encroachment in Assam. Chief Ministers of Assam and Arunachal Pradesh appealed for peace in the region, urging people to refrain from violence. "I appeal to the people of Assam and Arunachal to maintain peace and harmony. Boundaries may define our States, but they can never divide our hearts," Assam Chief Minister Himanta Biswa Sarma posted on X. Tagging his Arunachal Pradesh counterpart Pema Khandu and Union Home Minister Amit Shah, the Assam CM said that the two Northeastern states share a bond that goes far beyond boundaries.

"For generations, our people have lived as brothers and sisters, bound by love, affection and mutual respect," he added.

Sarma stressed that the two states have resolved most of their border differences through dialogue and friendship in recent years. "Only 52 villages remain, and both Governments will continue discussions in the same spirit to resolve the dispute completely," appealed Sarma.

"Assam and Arunachal Pradesh share a deep bond of history, friendship and brotherhood. Our differences must always be addressed through dialogue, mutual understanding and peaceful means," CM Khandu posted on X. He also appealed to people on both sides of the border not to allow

the recent developments to affect the long-standing ties between the two States. Meanwhile in Delhi, the MPs from Assam and Arunachal Pradesh appealed to the people living along the border of the two states to maintain peace, live harmoniously and resolve their differences through dialogue.

Assam and Arunachal Pradesh share an 804.1-km border in Udalguri, Sonitpur, Biswanath, Lakhimpur, Dhemaji, Tinsukia, Dibrugarh and Charaideo districts. There are 1,200 points of dispute along the inter-State border between the two States. The Assam Government on July 29 told the Assembly that Arunachal Pradesh has encroached upon 16,144.01 hectares of land. Out of this encroached land, Arunachal Pradesh is claiming 858.91 sq km. Both the States have constituted 12 regional committees for resolving the border disputes, and are taking steps to resolve these issues based on recommendations of these committees, which have jointly toured the areas and held consultations with stakeholders. A Namsai Declaration was signed by the CMs of the two States on July 15, 2022, setting in motion measures to resolve differences in 123 villages of Assam claimed by Arunachal Pradesh. An MoU in this regard was later signed by the two CMs in the presence of the Union Home minister in the national capital on April 20, 2023. Out of the 123 villages claimed by Arunachal Pradesh, the differences in 71 villages have been resolved and the process is on to address the issues in the remaining 52 villages.

Air India orders drug tests for all pilots

The airline said the decision followed concerns raised by employees and was aimed at protecting the confidence passengers place in the carrier.

The move comes after an incident involving an Airbus A320neo operating from Phuket to Delhi. The aircraft, which had 137 passengers and eight crew members on board, suffered a sudden loss of altitude of around 300 feet during the flight before continuing to Delhi and landing safely. The incident left 13 passengers and four crew members injured.

Under DGCA regulations, crew members operating scheduled flights from India must undergo a pre-flight breathalyzer examination at the first departure airport during their flight-duty period. A crew member who operates without completing the mandatory test can be removed from the roster at the first landing point, with the incident reported to the aviation regulator.

The Aircraft Rules, 1937, separately prohibit operating crew from consuming alcohol, sedatives, narcotic drugs or stimulants within 12 hours before commencing a flight or while a flight is in progress. Crew members are also prohibited from reporting for duty while intoxicated or with detectable alcohol in their blood. DGCA procedures require positive or missed alcohol tests to be reported to the regulator within 24 hours. While alcohol can generally be detected through breath or blood testing, drug screening involves the collection of biological samples and laboratory analysis to confirm the presence of prohibited substances.

Monsoon Session fell victim to Rahul Gandhi’s ego: BJP

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

The BJP on Thursday accused Congress leader Rahul Gandhi of repeatedly changing goalposts on discussions in Parliament and alleged that the Monsoon Session had fallen victim to “one leader’s ego, indiscipline and insolence”.

Lok Sabha was adjourned sine die on Thursday, drawing curtains on a stormy Monsoon Session that saw relentless protests by the Opposition over the police action against agitating students and the alleged theft of Ram temple donations, besides the passage of several key bills without debate.

Addressing a press conference on the last day of the Monsoon Session, senior BJP leader and MP Ravi Shankar Prasad alleged that the Opposition did not allow Parliament to function despite the Government’s readiness for discussions.

Calling Gandhi irrespons-



Union Minister Kiren Rijiju, MoS Jitendra Singh, Arjun Ram Meghwal, BJP MP Nitin Nabin and others stand at attention during the rendition of ‘Vande Mataram’ in Rajya Sabha during the Monsoon Session of Parliament in New Delhi on Thursday

ble and “immature”, Prasad accused him of lacking political propriety.

“I would like to repeat that Rahul Gandhi is irresponsible. Rahul Gandhi is yet to mature as a leader in the politics of the country. Rahul Gandhi is delinquent. And Rahul Gandhi has a great sense of arrogance and entitlement,” he said.

“The Parliament’s Monsoon Session has fallen victim to one leader’s ego,

discipline and insolence,” he added. He said that Gandhi and the opposition kept changing the goalposts during the entire Monsoon Session. Prasad said that the opposition had first demanded a discussion on NEET, then Gandhi staged a protest outside the Prime Minister’s residence, demanded the resignation of the education minister, and later sought answers from Modi.

Govt was rattled during Monsoon Session; Opposition unity was on display: Congress

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

The Congress on Thursday claimed that never before had a Government been so “scared and rattled” as the Modi Government was during the just-concluded Monsoon Session, and the BJP leadership was seen “running away” from Parliament.

The Congress also claimed that opposition unity and solidarity was on full display during the entire duration of the session.

Congress general secretary in-charge communications Jairam Ramesh said Prime Minister Narendra Modi and Home Minister Amit Shah stayed away from parliamentary proceedings, appearing only on the last day just before the House was adjourned sine die.

“I want to remind you that the Monsoon Session has been washed out and 11 years ago in 2015, the Monsoon Session was washed out and the reason



Lok Sabha LoP Rahul Gandhi, Congress MP KC Venugopal and others stand at attention during the rendition of ‘Vande Mataram’ in the House during the Monsoon Session of Parliament in New Delhi on Thursday

was the Vyapam scam. After 11 years, again an issue related to the youth resulted in a washout,” Ramesh said at a press conference here alongside Congress’ Deputy Leader in the Lok Sabha Gaurav Gogoi.

“So, nothing has changed in 11 years. There were laws made and now reels are being made but nothing has changed,” Ramesh said.

Opposition unity was on display during the session as leaders of the INDIA bloc would meet every day in the chamber of Mallikarjun

Kharge, he said. “We walked together on the path we collectively decided,” Ramesh said. The Rajya Sabha Sabha MP said there were five big achievements for the Congress and the opposition in this session.

He said one success was that the ‘One Nation, One Election’, which the Government wanted to bring, was put off till the Winter Session as the opposition raised several questions and the report was not brought.

Owaisi appears in Hapur court to record statement in 2022 firing case

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ Hapur (UP)



Additional Superintendent of Police Vineet Bhatnagar said tight security arrangements were in place at the Hapur district court complex and surrounding areas in view of the Hyderabad MP’s arrival. Additional police personnel were deployed at the court premises with special security arrangements made for Owaisi’s movement to and from the court, he added.

Owaisi was returning to Delhi after campaigning for the Uttar Pradesh assembly elections on February 3, 2022, when shots were allegedly fired at his convoy near the Chhijarsi toll plaza in Pilkhuwa. He escaped unhurt

in the attack. Police had arrested Sachin, a resident of Duriyaai in Gautam Buddh Nagar, and Shubham, a resident of Sapla Begampur in Saharanpur’s Nakur area, in connection with the case.

During interrogation, the two allegedly told police that the weapons used in the attack had been provided by Alim, a resident of Radhna village in Meerut’s Mundali area. Alim was subsequently arrested and booked under Section 120B (criminal conspiracy). The three accused are currently out on bail.

The charge sheet names 60 witnesses, including 12 police personnel. The case has been pending before the court since then.

Govt orders Ola, Uber, Rapido, InDrive to remove advance tipping features



PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

In a major relief for millions of daily commuters, the Union Ministry of Road Transport and Highways (MoRTH) has directed Ola, Uber, Rapido, and InDrive—to remove “advance tipping” and “add-on” features from their mobile applications that suggest passengers can improve their chances of getting a cab by paying extra before a trip begins.

The Government stated that demanding extra money from passengers to secure or expedite bookings is a violation of consumer rights and goes against established aggregator guidelines. The Government stated that the Motor Vehicle Aggregator Guidelines, 2025, do not permit such practices.

Complaints regarding pre-ride tip messages prompted the directive. Previously, commuters during peak hours or bad weather were frequently forced to pay premiums ranging from ₹10 to ₹100 just to get their rides

accepted. Ride-hailing services were previously instructed to cease the practice by the Central Consumer Protection Authority. Passengers will have one fewer choice when making a reservation. Only after your trip is over will you be able to see the tip choice.

Under Clause 14.15 of the Motor Vehicle Aggregator Guidelines, 2025, tips must be voluntary and can be offered only after the journey ends. It applies to all motor vehicle aggregators under the Motor Vehicles Act, 1988. The entire tip must go to the driver. The aggregator cannot deduct anything from it. The tip cannot be available: at booking, before the journey begins, or during the journey. The tipping option cannot be shown at the booking stage, before the ride starts, or while the trip is in progress.

“No tipping feature or mechanism shall be provided in the App that is misleading, manipulative, or otherwise in violation of the Consumer Protection Act, 2019,” the ministry said.

LS records one of its lowest productivity in 20 years: PRS data

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

The Lok Sabha recorded one of its lowest productivity levels in more than two decades during the Monsoon Session that ended on Thursday, with only two Parliament sessions since 2004 showing lower functioning, according to data compiled by PRS Legislative Research.

The figures over the past 22 years show wide swings in parliamentary functioning, from sessions where the Houses sat well beyond their scheduled hours to those where political confrontation consumed most of the time available for business.

For the Lok Sabha, the just-concluded session falls among the worst. At 15 per cent, it matches the Winter session of 2016 and is ahead only of Winter 2010 and Winter 2013, when the House functioned for five per cent and eight per cent of its scheduled time respectively, according to the PRS data.



The Rajya Sabha fared better than the Lok Sabha but still functioned for only 33 per cent of its scheduled time, according to PRS, an independent, not-for-profit group that researches and tracks the functioning of Parliament and state legislatures.

Parliamentary Affairs Minister Kiren Rijiju, however, said the productivity of the Lok Sabha during the Monsoon Session was 19 per cent and that of the Rajya Sabha 39 per cent. Responding to a query on the slight variance, PRS maintained that it calculates House productivity by dividing the actual hours Parliament functioned in a session by the total planned sitting hours for that session.



Ministry of Culture
Government of India

PARTITION HORRORS REMEMBRANCE DAY

14 August, 2026

A day to remember one of humanity's greatest tragedies and honour the memory of the irreparable loss, pain, and trauma endured by the victims and survivors of partition

“Partition Horrors Remembrance Day is a reminder of our enduring responsibility to strengthen the bonds of harmony that hold our country together.”

-Narendra Modi
Prime Minister





Special observance programs in honour of partition victims on 14 August, 2026

Time: 3:00 pm onwards Venue: Golden Jubilee Auditorium, GNDU, Amritsar, Punjab	Time: 5:00 pm onwards Venue: Central Park, Connaught Place, New Delhi	Time: 4:30 pm onwards Venue: New Town Convention Centre, Kolkata, West Bengal
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On this day, let us endeavour to strengthen our commitment to oneness and inspire future generations with the values of peace, compassion and social harmony

Let us participate in nationwide tributes:

Candlelight
Marches

Plays on the
Theme of Partition

Exhibitions
on Partition

Educational
Seminars

For more information visit : amritkaal.nic.in | Scan this QR



CBC 09101/13/0018/2627

Vaishnaw walks Union ministers through the railways' war room

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

Union Railway Minister Ashwini Vaishnaw on Thursday explained the functioning of the Railways War Room to Union Minister for Parliamentary Affairs and Minority Affairs Kiren Rijiju and Union Minister for Labour & Employment and Youth Affairs & Sports Dr. Mansukh Mandaviya.

During the visit, Vaishnaw showed how the War Room uses live railway station feeds, AI-based systems and operational data to monitor railway activities and support timely action.

The War Room provides live feeds of railway stations, including platforms, foot-over bridges and areas outside the station. Live feeds



from stations such as New Delhi and Hazrat Nizamuddin can be monitored from a central location.

Officials can also zoom into individual camera feeds

to examine a particular location in greater detail. The system can respond to prompts and provide information about what happened at a particular location,

helping officials understand incidents more quickly.

During rush periods, festivals and high-footfall occasions, the War Room can be used to monitor activity across stations and keep track of changing passenger movement. The system also tracks train movement and delays, helping officials identify which trains are delayed and understand the reason for the delay.

This information can help railway teams assess the situation and determine what action is required to prevent further delays. The Union Ministers got a firsthand look at how the Railways War Room uses live station feeds, AI-based analysis and train movement data to monitor railway operations, official sources said.

Nurse found dead in washroom of state-run hospital in Kolkata

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ Kolkata

A nurse was found dead in a washroom of the state-run NRS Medical College and Hospital in Kolkata, hours after she joined duty, the police said on Thursday.

The police have started an investigation into her death, while the health department also formed a separate team to probe into the matter.

Health Minister Dr Sharadwat Mukherjee visited the hospital on Thursday morning and spoke to those



on duty with her the previous night. The 30-year-old nurse was on night duty at the hospital's high-dependency unit (HCU) on Wednesday.

According to the preliminary investigation, she reported for duty around 8 pm and

went to the staff washroom at the antenatal ward in the Gynaecology Department Building around 10.30 pm, police said.

"When she did not return for some time, her colleagues went to check on her and found the washroom door locked. After repeated knocks drew no response, two of them broke open the door and found her lying unconscious on the floor," a police officer said.

A doctor was called to examine the nurse, and she was subsequently declared dead, he said. Personnel from

Entally police station, along with officers of the Detective Department's Homicide team, reached the hospital after being informed about the incident, the officer said.

The preliminary investigation found no visible injury marks on the body, and no suicide note was recovered, he said.

Several medicine vials were reportedly found near her body, prompting investigators to examine whether she had taken the vials with her to the washroom while on duty.

Restoring J&K Statehood first step towards rebuilding democratic institutions: Farooq

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ Srinagar

National Conference (NC) president Farooq Abdullah on Thursday said the restoration of statehood to Jammu and Kashmir is an indispensable first step towards rebuilding democratic institutions and restoring the constitutional and democratic rights of the people.

Abdullah made these remarks while addressing a

gathering here.

The three-time chief minister described the restoration of statehood as one of the "most urgent necessities" before J-K.

"Restoration of statehood is an indispensable first step towards rebuilding democratic institutions and restoring the constitutional and democratic rights of the people," he said.

He also expressed concern over continuing wars, violence,



oppression, human rights violations and excessive use of force in Palestine, Lebanon, Iran and other parts

of the world.

"The continued killing and targeting of innocent children, women and elderly people is deeply tragic and a grave concern for humanity," he said.

The NC president expressed alarm over the destruction of hospitals, schools, universities, power stations and other essential infrastructure, saying that human values, democratic principles and international

Bihar minister meets Shah, discusses cooperative sector

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

Bihar's Cooperation Minister Ram Kripal Yadav on Wednesday met Union Home and Cooperation Minister Amit Shah at Parliament House in New Delhi and held detailed discussions on the progress, achievements and key issues concerning the cooperative sector in Bihar.

During the meeting, Yadav apprised Shah of the steps being taken to

The Bihar minister also informed the Union minister about ongoing efforts towards computerisation of cooperative societies in the state, development of Primary Agricultural Credit Societies (PACS) as multipurpose service centres, expansion of banking services under the 'Sahakarita mein Sahakar' initiative, training of PACS and cooperative officials, and linking cooperative products with national and international markets.



strengthen the cooperative movement in the state and to deliver greater benefits to farmers.

The discussions covered major initiatives, including the establishment of a cooperative sugar mill at Sakri in Madhubani district, the Bihar State Cooperative Policy-2026, implementation of the Pradhan Mantri Fasal Bima Yojana, promotion of vegetable processing and marketing, the world's largest grain storage scheme, and membership of interstate cooperative societies.

Yadav raised several important demands aimed at accelerating the cooperative sector in Bihar. These included faster computerisation of PACS, development of multipurpose service centres, expediting Minimum Support Price (MSP) payments to farmers, and ensuring timely release of funds to the State Food Corporation (SFC).

Amit Shah appreciated the efforts being made to strengthen the cooperative sector in Bihar and assured necessary support and guidance.

Nation Focus



Youth should play active role in politics: CM Mohan Yadav

Chief Minister Mohan Yadav inaugurated the 'Youth Parliament 2026' at the Madhya Pradesh Legislative Assembly on Thursday and called upon the youth to actively participate in politics.

Addressing more than 50 youngsters from 12 states, he said, "Youth should study and become doctors and engineers, and also enter politics to strengthen democracy. The youth of the country must actively participate in politics. Only the youth will strengthen democracy."

Netaji Subhas Chandra Bose, after passing the ICS exam, gave a befitting reply to the British by rejecting the job, and jumped into the freedom movement "to free Mother India from the chains of slavery," the chief minister said.

(PTI)



Urgent action needed to retain Chakan firms: Sharad Pawar

NCP (SP) chief Sharad Pawar on Thursday expressed concern over 20 companies in the Chakan industrial belt planning to shift their operations due to severe traffic congestion and inadequate infrastructure, and urged the Maharashtra Government to take urgent steps to retain industries and protect jobs.

In a post on X, Pawar said the decision by 20 companies employing more than 2,000 workers to relocate was a "serious matter". He said problems related to traffic, pollution, water supply, electricity and roads were forcing industries to consider moving out of Chakan MIDC. "Industries should not be forced to relocate, employment opportunities should be protected and the industrial strength of the state should be maintained," Pawar said.

(PTI)

RG Kar: Ex-TMC MLA arrested after CM intervention

SAUGAR SENGUPTA
■ Kolkata

The police on Thursday arrested former Trinamool Congress MLA and powerful North 24 Parganas leader Nirmal Ghosh for his alleged involvement in the "hurried cremation" of the victim of RG Kar Medical College rape and murder case.

The arrest was made days after Bengal Chief Minister Suvendu Adhikari announced during a memorial programme of the victim that not one person involved in the case would be spared. "Within the limited jurisdiction I have in this case, I am committed to that cause. We have not forgotten Abhaya, not forgotten her at all," the Chief Minister had said.

Ghosh was picked up from Sambalpur in Odisha and was being brought to Kolkata, sources said adding his arrest was based upon a fresh complaint made by the father of the victim on Monday. The father of the victim named two other persons also. They include TMC's former Panihati Municipality chairman, Somnath Dey, and the



family's neighbour, Sanjib Mukherjee. The Thursday's development comes amid reports of an on-duty nurse found dead under mysterious circumstances inside the washroom of NRS Medical College and Hospital in Kolkata.

Then a sitting MLA Ghosh in connivance with some other influential persons of Panihati in North 24 Parganas had allegedly hijacked the body of the victim soon after the postmortem ignoring the demand by her family members and protesters for a second postmortem at an

"neutral venue." The post-mortem was conducted post sundown and inside the same hospital where she was murdered in utter defiance of the established Supreme Court guidelines.

Symbolically known as "Abhaya" in Bengal the victim was a lady doctor pursuing her postgraduate course at RG Kar Medical College. She was raped and murdered in the night intervening August 9 and 10 of 2024 sending ripples throughout the country, making international headlines.

While one Sanjay Rai a

civic volunteer was awarded life sentence as the sole accused in the case some other persons including Sandip Ghosh the then Principal of the College and a police inspector and two doctors were subsequently arrested and facing trial for associated offences.

The Chief Minister had already suspended top police officials including then Kolkata Commissioner of Police Vineet Goyal and two other IPS officers for dereliction of duty and offering cash to the victim's kin.

Nirmal Ghosh's son Tirthankar was arrested on July 13 for his involvement in post 2024 elections violence. The senior Ghosh too was named in a number of other cases including post poll violence and a lottery fraud case.

Reacting to the Thursday's development BJP MLA Sourav Sikdar said that "the arrest of such powerful persons itself proves that the police had been freed from the shackles unlike in the previous (Mamata Banerjee) regime when they had to hid beneath the table. With the BJP and honourable Suvendu

Adhikari in power the police have started doing what they should do." Another MLA Sajal Ghosh said, "BJP Government will do whatever it can to bring the guilty to justice."

The Thursday's development comes amid reports of yet another mysterious death inside another medical college in Kolkata. Rupali Burman an on-duty nurse was on Wednesday night found dead inside a washroom of the NRS Medical College and Hospital.

The 30-year-old Rupali Burman was found dead inside the washroom of the Gynaecology Department's High Dependency Unit (HCU). Joint CP Crime Kunal Agarwal said that the matter was noticed around 10.30 at night," adding she was found inside the bathroom which was closed from inside and the doors had to be broken open.

"No suicide has been established so far. The forensic team will conduct investigation and CCTV footage is also being investigated," he said adding three injection vials were found beside her person.

Netaji insult row: West Bengal strips BJP MP of State honour

SAUGAR SENGUPTA
■ Kolkata

Even as the Netaji Subhash Chandra Bose humiliation row threatened to snowball into a major controversy the Bengal Government on Thursday moved swiftly stripping the prestigious Banga Bibhushan Award from Rajya Sabha MP Anant Maharaj for his "derogatory remarks" against the iconic freedom fighter.

This even as one person from Islampur in North Bengal was on Thursday arrested following stern warning by Chief Minister Suvendu Adhikari asking people to withdraw derogatory posts from the Net. The Award was withdrawn following a notification from the State Information and Culture Department cancelling the honour.

The Government notification read: "The Government of West Bengal hereby withdraws and annuls the Banga Bibhushan conferred upon Shri Nagendra Ray alias Ananta Maharaj on 21st February, 2026 with immediate effect. Consequently, Shri Nagendra



Rajya Sabha MP Anant Maharaj

Ray alias Ananta Maharaj shall cease to be entitled to represent himself as a recipient of the Banga Bibhushan and shall not hereafter use, claim or derive any recognition, privilege or benefit specifically arising from such conferment."

The state Government's order, would not however, refer to any specific comment or incident.

Earlier the Chief Minister had said that "the Government will not tolerate any insult to Netaji who is a national icon... all such posts should immediately be deleted from the social media and those who have done so must apologise though such apology do not guarantee any relief from legal action."

He said that "any person howsoever high one is will have to bear the consequence of insulting Netaji ... the Government will take strict action against them." He however would not take any name in particular.

Maharaj a former leader of Greater Cooch Behar People's Association and presently a BJP Rajya Sabha MP however continued to remain defiant saying his statements were sufficiently buttressed by facts.

The leader who had earlier referred to Netaji as a war criminal who had 'stolen British army and led them against the British Government justifying a counter attack' from the colonial rulers said, "I don't speak without documents it is not me who is talking it is the records that are speaking," he said.

Bengal BJP president Samik Bhattacharya publicly "discredited" such elements who would use derogatory words against Netaji "because he resides in the hearts of the Bengalis and people of India." He said, "anyone political or apolitical who dares insult him should be strongly dealt with."

India leading sustainable future for elephants: Environment minister

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

India is pioneering a sustainable future for elephants by combining cutting-edge technologies like artificial intelligence (AI), remote sensing, and geospatial mapping with traditional knowledge to protect their habitats, Minister of State for Environment Kirti Vardhan Singh said on Thursday.

He also underlined the need for cross-sectoral engagement, community participation and scientific approaches to reduce human-elephant conflict



while ensuring the well-being of local communities.

Singh made these comments during an event to mark World Elephant Day 2026 -- celebrated on August

12 every year -- in Visakhapatnam.

"India's commitment to elephant conservation is not merely a policy choice, but a reflection of our civilisation-

al values and ecological responsibility," he added.

The minister highlighted that with 33 elephant reserves, 150 scientifically identified elephant corridors and nearly 60 per cent of the world's wild Asian elephant population, India continues to play a leading role in elephant conservation.

"Human-elephant conflict is a complex issue and it requires a coordinated solution by including various stakeholders and utilising scientific data after its ground-level validation," Singh said.

Law and order has deteriorated in Andhra Pradesh: Jagan

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ Panchalingala (Andhra Pradesh)

YSRCP president YS Jagan Mohan Reddy on Thursday alleged that law and order had deteriorated in the state and accused the TDP-led coalition Government of pursuing vindictive politics and targeting Backward Classes (BCs).

Speaking to reporters after meeting YSRCP MLA Virupakshi at the local jail here in Kurnool district, the former chief minister alleged that the Government was filing false cases against victims and Opposition leaders to silence them and was particularly targeting BCs, whom he described as the party's support base.

"Law and order has deteriorated in



the State, while the TDP-led coalition Government is pursuing vindictive politics and targeting Backward Classes," Reddy charged. He alleged that the motive was to trouble political adversaries by foisting false cases and warned that those responsible would have to repent in the coming days.

There was no immediate reaction

from the ruling TDP. The YSRCP chief further alleged that false cases had been registered against Virupakshi, with the sitting MLA, his relatives and followers being booked in fabricated cases involving 38 people.

Police entered the MLA's house at night, damaged CCTV cameras and arrested him while imposing serious charges, he claimed.

He further alleged that a TDP worker tore his wife's clothes and blamed the incident on the MLA to enable police to invoke provisions of the Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes (Prevention of Atrocities) Act.

He claimed police had refused to register a case despite being shown evidence of an attack on a YSRCP cadre's house.

Vande Mataram played in Parliament for first time as Monsoon Session ends

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

In a historic first, the national song Vande Mataram was played to open the final Monsoon Session proceedings on Thursday.

The move came days after a new law granted the National Song legal protection and set rules for official renditions.

On the last day of the Monsoon Session, Lok Sabha proceedings

opened with Vande Mataram on Thursday, marking a first for Parliament, with Prime Minister Narendra Modi, Congress MP Rahul Gandhi and a full house in attendance.

After six stanzas of the National Song were played, the Lower House was subsequently adjourned sine die, bringing the session to a close. Lok Sabha Speaker Om Birla did not read out the usual valedictory address in



which he highlights the performance and productivity of the Lok Sabha during the session. Meanwhile, the Rajya Sabha was also adjourned sine die with the National Song.

The development comes days after President Droupadi Murmu gave her assent to legislation providing legal protection to Vande Mataram. The law makes intentional disruption or prevention of the singing of the National Song a

punishable offence, placing it on a similar legal footing to the National Anthem.

The Government had earlier issued protocols governing the singing at official functions. In an order dated January 28, the Union Home Ministry prescribed that six stanzas of the song be sung on occasions including the arrival of the President, unfurling of the Tricolour and addresses by governors.

Vizhinjam port to commence EXIM operations from August 18, says Kerala CM Satheesan

TR SREEHARSHAN
■ Thiruvananthapuram

Kerala Chief Minister VD Satheesan on Thursday said export-import operations at the Vizhinjam International Seaport would commence from August 18 after it received all necessary clearances, including from Customs.

Speaking at a press conference here, the CM said the commencement of EXIM operations would be the first step towards enabling the state to directly be nefit from the port's activities. The Customs commissionerate has issued the necessary notifications for the commencement of export-import operations, he said.

The port had thus far been handling only transshipment



operations, with more than 60 per cent of the containers handled there being linked to other countries, Satheesan said. To support EXIM operations, a temporary arrangement has been made to connect the port road to NH-66, following directions from the National Highways Authority of India, he said.

A Customs-bonded area

has also been established inside the port, as Thiruvananthapuram does not have a Container Freight Station, Satheesan added.

Responding to queries about the proposed transfer of a stake in Adani Ports and Special Economic Zone Ltd's Vizhinjam port venture to a foreign shipping company, Satheesan said an

empowered committee headed by the chief secretary was examining the matter and had not yet submitted its report.

"There is currently no urgency to permit it. The Centre has to give permission with regard to the strategic and security aspects of the transaction.

After they do that, we will decide by taking into account the interests of the state," Satheesan said.

In June, APSEZ announced that Switzerland-based Mediterranean Shipping Company, the world's largest shipping and logistics group, would acquire a 49 per cent stake in Adani Vizhinjam Port Private Ltd, the concessionaire of Vizhinjam port, for about \$1.4 billion.

ED raids across Punjab in probe into illegal industrial plot allotments by PSIEC officials

PRAMOD KUMAR SINGH
■ New Delhi

The Enforcement Directorate's (ED) Jalandhar office has stepped up its money-laundering investigation into alleged illegal industrial plot allotments by Punjab Small Industries & Export Corporation officials. ED teams carried out searches at 11 locations in Chandigarh, Amritsar, Gurdaspur, and Ludhiana.

Officials also surveyed the PSIEC office. This action, carried out under the Prevention of Money Laundering Act, 2002, came after the Vigilance Bureau filed an FIR against several PSIEC officials and private individuals under the Prevention of Corruption Act, 1988 and the Indian Penal Code. According to the ED, industrial plots were given to people without technical industry experience, using fake companies and false addresses. These allotments were reportedly made possible by close connections with PSIEC officials, and the handover of plots was often delayed much longer than allowed.



Officials labelled the years in between as a "zero period," which let them move allotment dates forward and give beneficiaries more time to pay without interest. Investigators found that these illegal allotments were made in return for large bribes, paid either in cash or through complicated financial deals. Many plots went to shell companies and fake firms, then were sold at market prices to others, creating large illegal profits. In some cases, plots meant for

industry were split up and used for homes or businesses instead. During the searches, ED teams took incriminating documents and digital devices from several places. They also found unaccounted cash totalling ₹12.15 lakh. In addition, the bank accounts of two retired PSIEC officials, Surinder Pal Singh (former Chief General Manager) and Jaswinder Singh Randhawa (former General Manager), were frozen, with about ₹4.01 crore in total. The ED says these findings show a

pattern of abuse in the plot allotment process.

Officials are accused of helping relatives, friends, and associates by using the corporation's programs for personal gain. Shell companies and fake businesses hid who really benefited, making it possible to sell plots at market prices and turn public assets into private profits.

The investigation is still underway. Investigators are tracing the money, identifying additional beneficiaries, and looking into whether other officials or private individuals were involved. The case continues to raise concerns about transparency and accountability in how state-run corporations distribute industrial land.

"The ED's action under the PMLA is based on investigating suspected corruption as part of a money-laundering probe, with the power to seize and confiscate tainted assets. As the investigation continues, more details are expected about the extent of the alleged wrongdoing and the people involved", a senior official said.

Row in Rajya Sabha over purification ceremony after Kharge's Uttarakhand rally



Rajya Sabha LoP Mallikarjun Kharge speaks in the House during the Monsoon session of Parliament in New Delhi on Thursday PTI

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

A row erupted in the Rajya Sabha on Thursday after the Leader of Opposition (LoP) and Congress chief Mallikarjun Kharge alleged a 'shudhikaran' (purification) ceremony was held at the venue where he addressed a rally in Uttarakhand. Terming the incident "unfortunate," Union Minister JP Nadda asserted that the BJP does not subscribe to such activities.

The issue has already created a political stir in Uttarakhand, where the Congress and the BJP have been trading charges over the ritual at Haldwani's Ram Lila Ground. It was held by a right-wing outfit two days after Kharge, a

Dalit, addressed a public rally at the venue.

Raising the matter in the Upper House, Kharge claimed that BJP workers performed a "havan" and carried out a "purification" of the stage from which he addressed a rally on August 8. "There were lakhs of people present at the time. I did not name any community or religion. I only spoke about the problems faced by the people there. But after my speech, BJP workers performed a havan" he said.

"Is this the way in a democracy? How are you protecting the Constitution? I am the LoP... I never wanted to politicise these issues," Kharge, only the second Dalit leader to head the Congress, said.



भारत निर्वाचन आयोग
Election Commission of India



CHIEF ELECTORAL
OFFICER, HARYANA

SIR 2026

विशेष गहन पुनरीक्षण

हरियाणा

आपका मत, आपकी पहचान - हर संकल्प

फॉर्म-6

नए मतदाता के लिए

यदि आप 18 वर्ष की आयु पूर्ण कर चुके हैं और आपका नाम मतदाता सूची में नहीं है, तो फॉर्म-6 भरें।



नया नाम जोड़ने हेतु

फॉर्म-7

नाम हटाने के लिए

यदि किसी का नाम स्थानांतरित हो गया है, मृत्यु हो गई है या दोहराव है, तो फॉर्म-7 भरें।



नाम हटाने हेतु

फॉर्म-8

विवरण सुधारने के लिए

यदि आपके नाम, आयु, पता, फोटो या अन्य विवरण में कोई गलती है, तो फॉर्म-8 भरें।



विवरण सुधारने हेतु

उपरोक्त किसी भी फॉर्म के साथ आवश्यक दस्तावेज एवं घोषणा-पत्र संलग्न करें।

फॉर्म एवं आवश्यक दस्तावेज जमा करने के विकल्प



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VIJENDER GUPTA
Hon'ble Speaker, Delhi Legislative Assembly
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80th Independence Day



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Secretary
Delhi Legislative Assembly



Editor's
TAKE

The Western Ghats: A decade of delay

The Western Ghats have been mapped and studied for over a decade, yet there is no consensus on how much of this landscape must be protected, and at what cost?

On July 27, the Union Environment Ministry issued its seventh attempt since 2014 to notify Ecologically Sensitive Areas in the Western Ghats – proposing 56,825 square kilometres across six states where mining, quarrying, thermal power plants and large-scale construction would be restricted or banned. That it has taken seven drafts tells its own story: a policy first proposed in 2011 remains, in 2026, still unresolved.

The stakes are not abstract. The Ghats are one of the world's eight richest biodiversity hotspots, home to more than 7,000 species, and the source of the Godavari, Krishna and Kaveri river systems that sustain peninsular India's agriculture. They also shape the monsoon, and their degradation can cost lives.

Research shows the range's evergreen forest cover shrank from 16 per cent in 1985 to barely 11 per cent by 2018, even as construction and farmland crept upward – a trajectory that makes disasters like Wayanad more likely, not less.

Yet Kerala, Karnataka and Goa remain unpersuaded, even as Maharashtra, Gujarat and Tamil Nadu now have accepted it. Karnataka, which carries the largest share at 20,668 sq km, objects less to conservation itself than to the absence of compensation: the Kasturirangan committee had recommended states be paid for economic activity forgone, a promise never kept. Kerala wants roughly 1,200 sq km excluded, arguing the notification threatens tourism livelihoods in Wayanad and Idukki, where critics say even a modest resort risks being classed a polluting industry.

Goa fears it will halt the conversion of farmland into real estate, and wants iron-rich Sattari taluka excluded altogether. These are not frivolous objections – mining revenue, plantation economies built on coffee, tea and spices, and tourism receipts are real livelihoods, not abstractions. But the framing of ecology versus economy is largely false. Studies find villages near intact forest report double the agricultural yield of those without; and the ecosystem services the Ghats provide – flood control, water security, carbon storage – dwarf in value what a shrinking pool of quarries and townships could generate, while benefiting a population far larger than the six Ghats states alone.

The way forward does not require choosing between the two. It requires the Centre to finally operationalise the compensation mechanism it has promised for over a decade, through payment-for-ecosystem-services rather than platitudes. It requires precise, ground-truthed, village-level mapping to end boundary disputes fed as much by misinformation as by fact. And it requires distinguishing, as experts have long urged, between genuinely destructive activity – mining, quarrying, unregulated construction – and the sustainable agriculture and eco-tourism that can coexist with protection. The Sanjay Kumar committee now has until 2027 to settle this.

Another missed deadline will not be neutral: given what fragmentation is already doing to this landscape, it will be a decision dressed up as indecision. India has weighed the Western Ghats' fate for fifteen years. It cannot afford fifteen more.



ANURADHA
P S

India's banking story over the past decade has been one of remarkable transformation. The Pradhan Mantri Jan Dhan Yojana has helped millions enter the formal financial system. Payments through the Unified Payments Interface (UPI) were a game-changer in the digital payment landscape. The Reserve Bank of India's UDGM (Unclaimed Deposits-Gateway to Access Information) has also been a recent addition that allows customers and legal heirs to track down the deposits that they have forgotten in various banks.

The reforms have enhanced financial inclusion. But they also reveal a more muted problem that must not be overlooked when it comes to policy decisions - and it is one that needs to be addressed on a par: the lack of disconnect between savings and their proper owners.

The banks in the public sector transferred ₹60,518 crore in unclaimed deposits to the RBI's Depositor Education and Awareness (DEA) Fund as of January 2026. The regulators have made the recovery procedure possible during the 'Your Money Your Right' campaign, with ₹5,777 crore recovered through 22.95 lakh claims across the country, showing that it can work if institutions coordinate well. This is a great achievement and deserves credit. They also pose a more basic question, however. So many deposits are going unclaimed; why is that? The solution goes beyond banking.

An unclaimed deposit isn't a deposit that's simply put into the memory hole. It can usually be traced back to the interplay of demographic, family fragmentation, migration, lack of nominee information, financial illiteracy, and sluggish succession processes. Typically, senior customers outlive their financial plan and legal beneficiaries do not know of their accounts or may have trouble accessing paperwork after the customer's death. India's financial reforms have been mainly directed towards facilitating access for people to the banking system. The next step will be to make sure that financial assets are not separated from their owners throughout their lives and that they pass on to their nominees or legal heirs.

This is the shift from financial inclusion to financial continuity.

Financial inclusion is asking the question, "Can everyone have a bank account?" Financial continuity asks: "Is there a continuity of financial assets, and do they continue as identifiable, accessible and transferable assets?"



TYPICALLY,
SENIOR
CUSTOMERS
OUTLIVE THEIR
FINANCIAL PLAN
AND LEGAL
BENEFICIARIES
DO NOT KNOW
OF THEIR
ACCOUNTS OR
MAY HAVE
TROUBLE
ACCESSING
PAPERWORK
AFTER THE
CUSTOMER'S
DEATH

The writer is Professor,
Department of Commerce,
CHRIST University



RACHNA
LAKHPATRI

2ND OPINION

There is a moment most of us know well, even if we have never named it. Someone says something that needed to be said. The timing was right, the words were chosen carefully, and the intent was clear. Nobody felt attacked. Nobody felt diminished. The truth landed, and somehow the relationship came out stronger for it. You walked away thinking, that was exactly what I needed to hear.

Now think of the other kind of moment. Same truth, different delivery. Same intent, different timing. And suddenly, a conversation that could have built something instead broke it. The difference was not the truth itself. It was the how, the what, and the when.

We talk endlessly about honesty as though it were simply a matter of saying the true thing. But anyone who has led a team, raised a child, managed a difficult client,

or held a friendship through turbulent years knows that honesty is the least of it. The real skill lies in knowing which truth to speak, how to frame it so it can actually be heard, and when the other person is in a place to receive it without it becoming something they need to defend themselves against.

We all witness this in our daily lives. This is not manipulation, but a version of leadership. And leadership, at its core, is nothing more than the sustained practice of balancing truth, relationships, and ethics under pressure, especially when emotions are running high, which is to say, most of the time.

Emotions are not the enemy here. They are information. When you feel the pull to soften a truth beyond recognition because you cannot bear to cause discomfort, that is worth examining. When you feel the urge to

LETTERS TO THE EDITOR

Justice Varma case exposes accountability gap

The report of the three-member inquiry committee constituted by the Lok Sabha Speaker has indicted Justice Yashwant Varma on three counts. The Justice Aravind Kumar-led committee found Varma's defence "evasive" and "unsatisfactory". In April, Varma resigned from the Allahabad High Court.

No judge of the High Court or Supreme Court has been removed from office so far, as each has chosen to quit when an impeachment motion was initiated.

According to some legal experts, since the impeachment motion was already tabled in Parliament when Justice Varma resigned, the process may be taken forward. Others say the Judges (Inquiry) Act, 1968, can only be invoked against a serving judge. Following the committee report, whether Varma will receive the perks and pension due to a retired High Court judge is also a matter of interest. The Aravind Kumar committee report has, for all practical purposes, dismissed the conspiracy charges against Varma.

The Yashwant Varma episode once again proves that while the cumbersome procedure to remove SC or HC judges is intended to protect them from pressure, there should be a mechanism to prevent them from quitting to escape admonition and punishment.

GANAPATHI BHAT | AKOLA

Challenges of Mecca Pact

The thought-provoking article 'A fitting response to Mecca Pact' and related editorial 'What the Mecca defence pact really means' (13 Aug) have deeply and comprehensively analysed the defence, strategic and financial implications of the Mecca Pact between Türkiye, Saudi Arabia and the junior partner, Pakistan. Hesitatingly calling it Islamic NATO may invite denials, but the potential Islamic bonding in the Mecca Pact can't be denied. Pakistan is more desperate about it for multiple reasons, primarily financial help from Saudi Arabia and arms supplies from Türkiye. Whether the Mecca Pact is an extension of US influence in the new architecture or a post-American security order will be known not immediately, but in the course of time.

The UAE is a global logistics and financial hub, while Saudi Arabia holds significant geopolitical and economic weight across the Arabian Peninsula. Operation Sindoar has exposed Pakistan's deep defence vulnerabilities, and Pakistan has miserably lost all wars against India. India is strongly positioned in any challenging scenario with its economic strength and maritime power. The MAHASAGAR initiative as the Indian Navy's flagship outreach programme and strategic vision and diplomacy is a powerful response to the triangular pact.

VINOD JOHRI | DELHI

Tata's future at a crossroads

Few business houses are as intertwined with India's economic journey as the Tatas. From steel, power and chemicals in the industrialising decades to automobiles, information technology, aviation and global acquisitions in the liberalised era, the group has repeatedly mirrored the country's economic transformation. The Tata story has rested on an unusual compact between enterprise, institution and public purpose.

Thus, N Chandrasekaran's decision to step down as chairman of Tata Sons is a rare event, less a resignation than the visible culmination of contradictions within the Tata edifice. His reappointment had remained unresolved amid differences with Tata Trusts over strategy, governance and the group's future direction.

The issue of Tata Sons' listing through an IPO may be at the core. The logic of a modern conglomerate – transparency, market valuation, capital flexibility and an exit route for minority shareholders - confronts the traditional Tata architecture of Trusts retaining controlling influence and philanthropy being integral to its identity. Deeper fault lines include Air India's losses, capital allocation, succession and the balance between management and the Trusts. The challenge is to reconcile Tata's legacy with global competitiveness.

R NARAYANAN | NAVI MUMBAI

PIC TALK



Students perform during the full-dress rehearsal for the 80th Independence Day, at Devi Lal Stadium in Gurugram. PHOTO: PTI

DIGITAL EXPERIENCE



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STUDENT CONCERNS NEED MEANINGFUL DEBATE BEYOND POLITICAL DIFFERENCES

The reported readiness of Union Home Minister Amit Shah to discuss student protests in Parliament provides an opportunity to address an issue with wider implications for the country's educational system and democratic institutions. Rahul Gandhi's reported comment that he is not interested in lectures, however, suggests that political differences could prevent a meaningful exchange. Parliament should rise above such differences and focus on students' concerns.

Student protests should not be viewed only through a political lens. Many demonstrations emerge from genuine concerns relating to examinations, recruitment, unemployment, fees, academic policies and institutional functioning. While peaceful protests must be respected, students should also ensure that their campaigns remain within

democratic and lawful limits. The authorities, meanwhile, should respond with sensitivity rather than relying solely on administrative measures.

The government and Opposition share responsibility for addressing student issues. The government should provide clear answers, while the Opposition should raise concerns constructively. Parliament must ensure disagreement leads to debate, not deadlock. Ultimately, young people need opportunities, fairness and confidence in public institutions. Political leaders should avoid turning student grievances into another arena for partisan confrontation. A sincere parliamentary discussion, followed by concrete action, would send a positive message that India's students are being heard and taken seriously.

RUKMA SHARMA | JALANDHAR

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Justice must not end with the verdict

The Supreme Court’s recent push to clear execution backlogs has shown that much can be achieved through existing judicial powers, without waiting for Parliament. But it has also exposed a deeper problem: unless courts can ensure timely compliance, justice may be delivered yet remain beyond the reach of those who have won it



VIVEK KUMAR SINGH

A litigant who obtains a civil decree after spending ten or fifteen years in court often discovers that the real battle begins after judgment. The decree-holder may spend several more years merely trying to secure compliance with the very order that has conclusively recognised his rights. For many litigants, the verdict is not the end of litigation but an entry

ticket to another queue.

India’s justice system is usually criticised for delays in adjudication. Equally serious, though far less discussed, is what may be called an enforcement deficit in civil justice. When final orders are routinely ignored, delayed or frustrated, subordinate courts and tribunals appear toothless - not because their decisions lack legal validity, but because they lack effective enforcement. The problem extends well beyond civil courts: Consumer Commissions, RERA Authorities, Labour Courts, Revenue Courts, Commercial Courts and numerous tribunals all see successful litigants forced into a second round of litigation just to realise the fruits of the first. The Supreme Court has repeatedly expressed concern over this state of affairs. In *Rahul S. Shah v. Jinendra Kumar Gandhi*, it directed that execution proceedings ordinarily be completed within six months, with reasons recorded for any extension. More recently, deciding a four-decade-old Tamil Nadu land dispute in *Periyammal v. V. Rajamani*, the Court went further. It directed every High Court to collect execution-pendency data from its district judiciary and issue an administrative circular requiring disposal within six months, with presiding officers held answerable for delay.

The results are instructive. In the six months after the March 2025 circular, 3,38,685 execution petitions were disposed of nationwide - yet pendency stood at a still-alarming 8,82,578 by October 2025, prompting the Court to extend the deadline by six months. A second wave followed and by April 2026, a total of 7,69,731 petitions had been cleared. But fresh filings kept arriving faster than courts could clear the backlog, and 7,95,981 petitions remained pending beyond six months when the matter was last reviewed. Karnataka’s High Court, which had failed to submit its data on time, was separately directed to devise its own disposal mechanism, and its executing courts were barred from allowing withdrawal-and-refiling without valid reason - a targeted fix imposed without any new legislation.

This is the clearest available demonstration that a great deal can be accomplished through existing supervisory and rule-making power, without waiting for Parliament. It is worth asking, though, why a circular producing three-quarters of a million disposals still leaves the backlog looking much as before. The likely answer is not that the mechanism failed, but that it addressed only half the problem. A time-bound circular pushes courts to dispose of petitions already filed, but does nothing to slow the rate at which judgment-debtors generate fresh obstruction to keep a petition alive past its deadline. Disposal speed and defiance are different problems - which is why the disclosure and contempt measures below matter as much as the timeline itself.

There is a second, more uncomfortable question the same episode raises - who enforces the enforcers? Karnataka’s High Court itself missed the Supreme Court’s own reporting deadline and had to be separately reminded before it complied. If administrative direction is the preferred route precisely because it moves faster than legislation, its speed still depends on High Courts choosing to comply with the Supreme Court the way judgment-debtors are meant to comply with executing courts. The honest answer is that this route trades one enforcement problem for a smaller, more visible one - a High Court answering to the Supreme Court is far easier to hold to account than a scattered judgment-debtor is to trace, but the dependency does not disappear, it simply moves up a level. The answer does not lie in bypassing the existing legal framework altogether. Sections 36 to 74 and Order XXI of the CPC already provide for elaborate execution machinery - attachment and sale of property, arrest and detention, appointment of receivers, delivery of possession. The difficulty is not the absence of legal provisions - it lies in prolonged delays and, in some cases, consequence-free defiance of lawful orders.

Other jurisdictions treat post-judgment compliance as



INDIA’S JUSTICE SYSTEM IS USUALLY CRITICISED FOR DELAYS IN ADJUDICATION. EQUALLY SERIOUS, THOUGH FAR LESS DISCUSSED, IS WHAT MAY BE CALLED AN ENFORCEMENT DEFICIT IN CIVIL JUSTICE

seriously as adjudication itself. England and Wales compel asset disclosure and back it with contempt proceedings, while the United States’ Rule 69 permits post-judgment discovery in aid of execution. The lesson is not that India should transplant a foreign model, but that enforcement needs active disclosure and credible consequences - exactly what Periyammal’s circulars did not supply.

The temptation, at this point, is to reach for a new law - a Civil Justice Compliance Act codifying timelines, mandating disclosure and layering on graded sanctions. The instinct is sound, but a standalone central statute would need to clear a crowded legislative calendar and navigate the fact that execution touches both Union and State List subjects. The Commercial Courts Rules, 2021 offer a cautionary tale. Their Chapter XII, proposing dedicated District Execution Cells, has sat unnotified by the Union government for five years, despite being fully drafted. Faced with that inertia, the Supreme Court in May 2026 told High Courts to constitute such cells on their own under existing supervisory jurisdiction - the strongest case yet for treating rule-making as the default route, and new legislation as the fallback.

Three concrete steps follow. First, generalise the Order XXI amendment that Periyammal has already begun. High Courts possess rule-making power under Section 122 CPC to supplement CPC procedure within their jurisdiction - though that power reaches procedure, not substantive rights, so it can fix timelines and disclosure duties but cannot itself create new categories of liability. Codifying the six-month benchmark, making asset disclosure mandatory rather than discretionary, and prescribing fixed compliance hearings at 90 and 180 days can be notified by individual High Courts, several of which already issue execution-specific circulars under Supreme Court supervision. Where uniformity is desirable, a focused CPC (Amendment) Bill limited to Order XXI is a far lighter lift than an entirely new statute.

Second, put real force behind disclosure and contempt tools that already exist. Order XXI Rule 41 already permits courts to examine judgment-debtors on their assets, but it is rarely invoked and carries weak consequences for non-compliance - making non-disclosure itself independently punishable would close much of the gap a new “mandatory disclosure” provision would otherwise address. Executing courts could similarly be empowered to certify deliberate, repeated defiance directly to the High Court for summary con-

tempt - as Karnataka’s courts effectively were on withdrawal and re-filing.

Third, build transparency through technology. A national execution-tracking dashboard, integrated with the existing e-Courts platform, could make pendency visible in real time - a pure implementation project, built substantially on data the ongoing court-by-court reporting to the Supreme Court has already generated. None of this forecloses a more comprehensive statutory framework later. But sequencing does matter. Administrative circulars produced three-quarters of a million disposals in thirteen months, at a speed no new statute could have matched, even as they proved unable to outrun the rate of fresh filings. Rule amendments and Practice Directions can be tested and refined if they misfire - a central Act, once passed, is far harder to correct. The prudent path is to exhaust what existing rule-making power can deliver, and treat new legislation as the tool of last resort.

Whichever instrument closes the remaining gap, it must carry the same safeguards, viz., prior notice, hearing, speaking orders, proof of wilful default, protection for bona fide third-party claims, exclusion of genuine inability to comply, and appellate remedies. Graded consequences - realistic costs, compulsory disclosure, temporary civil disabilities, expedited attachment - should precede civil detention, which should remain an exceptional last resort. The goal is predictability, not punitive excess. A litigant who has already succeeded should not face another prolonged struggle to secure compliance, and those who deliberately frustrate final orders should not profit from delay. Justice delayed is damaging. Justice unenforced is worse. Thirteen months of Supreme Court-driven administrative circulars have already shown what is achievable without new legislation, and how much further there is to go. That experience, not a hypothetical statute, should now anchor the reform agenda.

It is worth recalling the circular trigger. Ayyavoo Udayar signed a sale agreement for a modest plot in Salem in 1980 and sued for possession in 1983. He won his decree in 1986 but did not live to see it enforced - he died while the vendors’ appeal was pending, and his legal heirs carried the case through a second appeal, a dismissed Supreme Court petition in 2006, and an execution petition resisted for years by relatives claiming tenancy rights they could never quite document. It took until March 2025 - forty-five years after the original agreement - for the Supreme Court to order his heirs into possession within two months, and to use his family’s case to order every High Court to prevent the same thing happening to anyone else. Faith in justice is tested not when a verdict is pronounced, but when it is obeyed - and for one family in Salem, that test lasted forty-five years too long.

The writer is an ex-IAS officer and is presently Chairman, RERA Bihar. He served as Principal Secretary, Department of Revenue and Land Reforms, Bihar

The challenge of human-elephant coexistence



VK BAHUGUNA

Elephant Day 2026’. Incredible elephants are symbols of wisdom, strength, and prosperity in Indian and many other cultures. But this day should inspire us not only to celebrate but also to ask serious questions - are awareness and celebrations alone enough? As we observe Elephant Day this year, there is a need to think seriously beyond organising photography competitions, awareness campaigns, and cultural programmes.

Elephants are under serious threat from the loss of their habitat and continue to face many threats. Habitat loss due to fragmented forest areas, human-elephant conflict, poaching, and climate change are the main challenges. In the IUCN Red List of Threatened Species, the African elephant is classified as Critically Endangered, while both the African savanna elephant and the Asian elephant are listed as Endangered.

The cost of human-elephant conflict is very heavy. Thousands of people have lost their lives in India in recent years. In Assam, more than 1,147 people have died over the past decade, including 138 deaths recorded in 2025 alone, and 53 people have been killed so far in 2026. In Jharkhand, 22 people died in just 21 days between December 2025 and January 2026. In one incident, an elephant trampled seven people in West Singhbhum in a single night, including a family of five. In Odisha’s Dhenkanal district, a wild elephant killed three people while they were collecting minor forest produce from the forest. Several deaths have also occurred in the Nilgiri region of Tamil Nadu - including attacks on women working in tea plantations and elderly villagers. In the early days of August 2026 alone, reports emerged of approximately nine people being killed in several human-elephant encounters in India, including in Uttarakhand. These incidents show how deep and persistent the conflict is.

Yet, there are some successful examples of community-based coexistence that are noteworthy, and there is hope if we replicate these stories while celebrating Elephant Day. Some of these, to quote, are:

i) The “Hati Bandhu” (Friends of Elephants) initiative has been successful in Hatikuli Rongchar village, located on the Nagaon-Karbi Anglong border in Assam. Villagers have grown Napier grass, paddy, jackfruit, bananas, and other crops on vacant land for elephants. Around 200-800 bighas of land have been dedicated to elephant fodder. The result - crop damage has decreased drastically, and there have been no human or elephant deaths in the past eight years. In this regard, we must agree that elephants are very conscious and intelligent animals and become angry with humans for their loss of habitat, and if they know that humans are helping them, like in this village of Assam, they will not harm them. I am reminded of an incident I read in a book by the late Vinod Rishi, former Additional DG Wildlife under the Ministry of Environment and an eminent wildlife expert. In his latest book, he stated that in 1974, an elephant killed a village Pradhan and his servant (the servant tried to shoot the elephant and injured the enraged elephant, which trampled and killed both of them) while he was posted in Siliguri in West Bengal. But when he went to the village to discuss the compensation, he was surprised that people were opposed to any compensation for them as the Pradhan was a notorious animal killer and used to supply animal meat to visiting senior officials in Siliguri. But what caused him great surprise was the fact that while returning, he noticed the same elephant standing in the cremation ground near the bank of the river and preventing his family from collecting the ashes, and ultimately threw them into the river flowing. It shows that the elephant had marked him for revenge and knew his exploits.

ii) In Nepal’s eastern border village of Bahundangi, farmers have started growing crops that elephants do not like (tea, bay leaf, lemon), begun beekeeping, and formed rapid response teams. There have been no deaths in the area since 2015.

iii) Hanging solar fencing in the Manas National Park area of Assam has provided protection to dozens of villages. Crop losses decreased, and human deaths in fenced areas remained zero.

These examples prove that when local people are involved, alternative livelihoods are provided, and space is made for elephants, conflict can be reduced. Now the question is: what should be done for harmonious living? The authorities need to:

- work for habitat conservation and ensure protection of corridors;
- community-managed solar fences, bee fences, and early warning systems;
- elephant-resistant crops and alternative employment;
- prompt and transparent compensation; stopping the exploitation of captive elephants;
- the villagers as well as foresters must emulate the Assam village by creating food crops inside and outside the forests; and
- last but not least, strong law enforcement, research, and education.

World Elephant Day should, therefore, be a symbol not just of a one-day celebration, but of a year-round commitment. The safety of both elephants and humans will be possible only when we focus on landscape-based land-use policies, community participation, and long-term solutions. The message should remain clear - there is a need to move beyond celebration and take concrete action so that giant elephants and human beings can live peacefully alongside each other. People should understand the importance of elephants and other wild animals of their own accord and act like people in Assam and Nepal. At the same time, they should help the Forest Department so that the ecosystems of which elephants are an integral part can be protected. To quote Lord Buddha, “Awaken. Be a witness to your thoughts. The elephant pulls itself out of the mud. In the same way, you too should pull yourself out of your laziness.” This profound statement reflects the regal essence of the elephant in Indian tradition, connecting inner wisdom with the majestic presence of this animal of India’s national heritage. The elephant is India’s national heritage animal, symbolising grace, strength, and ecological memory. It is worshipped as Lord Ganesha, the remover of obstacles and god of wisdom. Let us all pledge to protect elephants while preserving their grace.



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Freedom at Midnight: The astrological twist behind India’s tryst with destiny



BP ACHARYA

with the concomitant inconveniences of participating with groggy eyes! Mercifully, this time around, we are spared such nocturnal celebrations. Yet, a question continues to linger in our minds: why on earth did we choose to be free at such an unearthly hour? Was it by choice or by compulsion? What was so special about that midnight hour for our “tryst with destiny”? If you have ever wondered, there hangs a fascinating, lesser-known tale that I recount below.

To answer these questions, I must jog my memory back to the 1980s, when I had a gap year as a research scholar at Jawaharlal Nehru University (JNU). Having completed my M Phil coursework with a high grade-point average, I was eligible to fast-track directly into a PhD programme. I registered for it, though it was not my immediate priority, simply because I was still underage to appear for the Civil Services Examination.

Since I was relatively free, my professor and

research guide asked me to assist the internationally celebrated authors Larry Collins and Dominique Lapierre - of Freedom at Midnight fame. They needed help editing a vast archive of personal papers and private documents belonging to Lord Louis Mountbatten, the last Viceroy of India, which they had gathered for their bestseller. That was how I found myself swamped with huge loads of primary historical material. My task was to ferret out insights for new publications, which were later brought out in two separate volumes: Mountbatten and the Partition of India and Mountbatten and Independent India.

It was during this deep archival dive that I stumbled upon a fascinating interview with Lord Mountbatten, conducted by the authors during their research for Freedom at Midnight. This recorded interview was published in the first volume of Mountbatten and the Partition of India. Characterised by his trademark arrogance and insouciance, the story is best heard straight from the horse’s mouth, as Mountbatten recounts the events in these interview excerpts:

Question: The ceremony of August 15 had no precedent. Who invented and engineered it?

Answer: Well, I discussed it with Nehru. The first and most amusing thing, of course, is that I had selected August 15 because it was the date of the Japanese surrender to me as the



Commander of the Allied forces in Singapore - which, don’t forget, had taken place only two years prior. However, I had not consulted the astrologers.

As you know, Indians are deeply invested in astrology. I did not realise it at the time, but on an inauspicious day, they would do nothing. While Nehru himself did not believe in astrology, he mentioned that so many others did, and that I had chosen an unpropitious day. I suppose it was silly of me not to consult the astrologers, but it had slipped my mind.

He then suggested, “Never mind. If you agree, we can hold a midnight meeting. Just before the clock strikes midnight, we will transfer power, which will make it all the more auspicious.”

I thought to myself - what a marvellous, dramatic idea, to hold a midnight meeting while the rest of the world sleeps! As you will remember,

tistical Viceroy, what remains surprising is that the Indian leaders rather meekly submitted to his whims and fancies.

When Nehru broached the subject with other leaders, there was apparently stiff resistance, particularly from Sardar Patel and JB Kripalani, both of whom wanted to avoid the inauspicious day. Ultimately, it was left to an ingenious astrological subterfuge to resolve this conundrum. This is how it was done.

As per the Hindu calendar, tithis (days calculated based on the solar/lunar cycle) begin at sunrise, whereas the Western (Gregorian) calendar dictates that a new date commences at midnight. This crucial difference afforded a slim window of opportunity to work out an astrological solution (upay) to a difficult dilemma.

According to astrologers, August 15, 1947, was a day to be avoided at all costs. It fell on the 14th

day (Chaturdashi) of the dark fortnight (Krishna Paksha), with the most inauspicious new moon day (Amavasya) also setting in. Thus, an innovative compromise formula was struck: by scheduling the transfer before the sunrise of August 15, they successfully avoided the inauspicious dark Chaturdashi and Amavasya under Hindu reckoning. Meanwhile, under the Gregorian calendar, August 15 would technically begin immediately after midnight. It was this ingenious tightrope walk that necessitated the midnight ceremony, and the rest is history.

This apparently win-win formula was actually a difficult compromise born out of compulsion rather than choice. We had no option when confronted by a supercilious Viceroy’s arbitrary choice of date, which smacked of scant regard for the people’s sentiments. However, what was indeed disappointing was the meek submission of Indian leaders to his whims and fancies, going out of their way to accommodate his peccadilloes. Thus, *Freedom at Midnight* became our “tryst with destiny” and, over time, a celebrated symbol of a dramatic transfer of power, later emulated in other colonial transitions like that of Hong Kong. For us, however, it remains a story of a queer compromise that defined the dilemmas of our country during the initial years after independence - dilemmas that linger on in more ways than one.

The writer is a retired Special Chief Secretary of Telangana



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Delhi HC seeks Govt's stand on CSC de-recognition



The Delhi High Court on Thursday sought the Centre's stand on a petition by the Central Secretariat Club (CSC) against the revocation of its recognition.

The club, formerly known as Talkatora Club, also assailed an eviction order by the Estate Officer asking it to immediately vacate its present premises in the President's Estate. Justice Swarana Kanta Sharma issued notice to the central Government and asked it to file its response to the petition. A senior counsel for the petitioner urged the court to pass an order directing status quo in the matter, stating that "nothing would be left" if such a protection was not granted.

Declining the request, Justice Sharma said, "I don't think so. List on August 24." In its petition, the club said that on July 14, the Department of Personnel and Training arbitrarily, illegally, and unconstitutionally, withdrew the recognition granted to it.

The petitioner said that instead of taking corrective action on its complaints regarding irregularities during the term of the ad hoc committee managing its affairs, the authorities first withdrew the recognition in February without issuing any show cause notice. (PTI)

DA case: Rahul moves SC against Allahabad HC order



Congress leader Rahul Gandhi has moved the Supreme Court challenging an order of the Allahabad High Court which directed the CBI and ED to verify the allegations of disproportionate assets against him.

As per the apex court cause list, a bench of Chief Justice Surya Kant and Justices Joymalya Bagchi and V Mohana is likely to hear the matter on August 17.

Expressing dissatisfaction with the CBI's response, the Allahabad High Court's Lucknow bench on July 20 had directed the agency's senior officer to personally file a fresh affidavit detailing the progress made in the probe into allegations of disproportionate assets against the Leader of Opposition in the Lok Sabha.

The high court had also observed that if, during the course of its inquiry into the allegations, the Enforcement Directorate (ED) comes across material and documents indicating any illegality, it would be free to proceed further in accordance with law.

The high court was hearing a plea that sought an investigation by the CBI and the ED into allegations of disproportionate assets against the Congress leader.

The order was passed after an in-chamber hearing lasting nearly two hours in the criminal writ petition filed by Karnataka resident S Vignesh Shishir.

Vignesh, a BJP worker, had earlier filed pleas alleging that the Congress leader holds dual citizenship. (PTI)

SC halts Odisha DGP selection till August 18

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

The Supreme Court on Thursday told the Union Public Service Commission (UPSC) not to finalise till August 18 the names of probable officers for appointment of the Director General of Police of Odisha.

A bench of Chief Justice Surya Kant and Justices Joymalya Bagchi and V Mohana sought responses from the UPSC and others on a PIL which alleged that the Odisha Government was trying to include a junior officer in the list of probable candidates for the DGP post, in breach of the apex court's directions in the 2006 Prakash Singh case. The incumbent DGP, Y B Khurania, will demit office on August 16 this year.

"We will take it up on August 18. You assist us on that day but don't finalise in the meanwhile," the bench told the counsel appearing for the UPSC. The bench was informed that the UPSC was slated to convene a meeting on Thursday. The counsel appear-



ing for the UPSC told the bench that no meeting would be convened by it on the issue till the next date of hearing. Senior advocate P Chidambaram, appearing for the petitioner, told the bench that on Wednesday, an officer of the rank of ADGP was promoted in Odisha.

The bench observed that no affected officer has approached the court on the issue. The counsel appearing for the state said there was no breach of the apex court's directions in the Prakash Singh case. Senior advocate Raju Ramachandran, who is assisting the top court as an amicus curiae in the Prakash



Supreme Court asks Govt to consider AI ethics guidelines

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

The Supreme Court on Thursday asked the Centre and others to consider suggestions given by a petitioner on framing binding guidelines on ethics and transparency in AI-based surveillance and content moderation.

A bench comprising Chief Justice of India Surya Kant and Justices Joymalya Bagchi and V Mohana was hearing a petition filed by advocate Narendra Kumar Goswami.

"Tell us what can we do," the bench told the petitioner at the outset.

Goswami said he was pressing one of the prayers made in the petition, which sought a direction to the Centre to file an affidavit disclosing all existing and proposed high-risk Artificial Intelligence (AI) systems used by the ministries or agencies in welfare, policing, surveillance and content regulation.



"Send your writ petition as a representation," the bench said, adding that it was a comprehensive petition. "We are not the experts. It is a highly technical issue and it is in policy domain," the bench said.

It observed that the issues raised in the petition needs formulation of appropriate policy or regulation.

The bench noted the petitioner had, in February this year, submitted a representation to the Government on

ethics, mandatory algorithmic impact assessments and bias audits, transparency in AI-based surveillance and content moderation, human-in-the-loop oversight for all high-risk Governmental AI systems, and data protection safeguards..."

The plea sought a direction to the Centre and others to conduct and make public within six weeks a comprehensive algorithmic impact assessment and independent bias audit of all existing AI systems deployed in welfare allocation, predictive policing, facial recognition and content moderation, and to disclose the complete inventory of such systems.

Besides other prayers, it also sought a direction to the Centre to take steps to enact a comprehensive parliamentary legislation regulating the development and deployment of AI by the State, consistent with the guidelines framed by the

SC agrees to hear plea on facial recognition at Jantar Mantar

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

The Supreme Court on Thursday agreed to hear a plea filed by a Rajya Sabha lawmaker challenging the alleged deployment of facial recognition technology and other biometric surveillance measures by Delhi Police during the recent student protest at Jantar Mantar here.

A bench of Chief Justice Surya Kant and Justices Joymalya Bagchi and V Mohana directed the matter be tagged with earlier petitions on the issue.

Senior advocate Menaka Guruswamy, appearing for Rajya Sabha MP AA Rahim, said there are two issues which are a matter of concern-facial recognition of protestors done by Delhi police and data stored by private companies.

"One maps your face and one is a vehicle. So spectacles are used and a vehicle is



also used. And that data is all taken without permission. These private entities host the data. In violation of the rules...", she submitted.

The bench said it would hear the petition along with other related matters.

Rahim, who is member of the Rajya Sabha from Kerala for the Communist Party of India (Marxist), has approached the top court seeking a declaration that the use of indiscriminate biometric surveillance at peaceful public assemblies is unconstitutional and should

be restrained until Parliament enacts a law specifically authorising and regulating such measures. The plea, filed through advocate Subhash Chandran KR, alleged that Delhi Police conducted biometric surveillance in a "complete legal vacuum".

It said neither the Delhi Police Standing Orders governing protests nor the Criminal Procedure (Identification) Act, 2022, authorises biometric surveillance of persons participating in civilian assemblies.

Govt agrees to give rail concessions to acid attack victims, tells SC

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

The Centre on Thursday told the Supreme Court that it has agreed in principle to formulate a policy for granting railway travel concessions to acid attack survivors to enable them to travel to well-equipped hospitals in cities for periodic treatment.

The top court asked the Centre to consider the issue of granting travel concessions to acid attack survivors "liberally".

A bench comprising Chief Justice Surya Kant and Justices Joymalya Bagchi and V Mohana took note of the submissions of

Additional Solicitor General Archana Pathak Dave, appearing for the Ministry of Railways, and asked her to file the draft policy on record within six weeks.

At the outset, the law officer said that a meeting has been held and it has been decided in principle that the acid attack survivors can be given railway concessions. She said the Centre proposes to extend the benefit under the "patient category" as it has reservations about placing acid attack survivors in a separate category among persons with disabilities.

"I can inform that they will put the acid attack victims in the patient category...



because they have some reservations about putting them under the disabled category as others in that disabled category are not given railway concessions," she added. "Putting them in the disabled category, that has now been statutorily

resolved, with the amendment through another petition before us," the CJI said.

"They are in the disabled category, but we will give them concession under the patient category because they require it for the purpose of going to the doctor and for

2020 Delhi riots: Court says unsafe to rely on tainted witness testimony

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

A court here has acquitted 13 accused in a 2020 northeast Delhi riots case, saying the testimony of the key prosecution witness was under a "shadow of doubt". Additional Sessions Judge Parveen Singh said the CCTV footage relied upon for identification was too poor to establish the identity of the accused persons.

"Considering the fact that this witness had suddenly become an eyewitness and in view of the above discussion that the testimony of PW8 as an eyewitness is under a shadow of doubt, it will be unsafe to rely upon the testimony of PW8 (prosecution witness 8)," the court said in its recent order.

The case pertained to an incident on February 25, 2020, in the New Usmanpur police station area, where Raman Chauhan was allegedly attacked during the communal violence. Chauhan told the court that he could not



identify any of the rioters who had attacked him.

An FIR was registered at New Usmanpur police station against 13 accused identified as Mohammad Anas, Mobin, Mohd. Javed Khan alias Shanu, Faisal, Shahjad Khan alias Montu, Imran Khan, Badshah Khan, Irfan Khan, Siraj Khan, Arman alias Arbaz, Aman alias Suhail and Iqbal Khan alias Sonu.

The accused faced charges including rioting, rioting armed with deadly weapons, attempt to murder, criminal conspiracy and disobedience of an order promulgated by a public servant.

SC expresses concern over pendency of cases at NCDRC

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

The Supreme Court on Thursday took serious note of the pendency of cases in the National Consumer Dispute Redressal Commission (NCDRC) and asked the Centre to consider setting up regional and circuit benches to clear the backlog.

The top court also called for performance audits of state and district consumer commissions. The forums should not become rehabilitation centres for retired judicial officers, it said.

A bench of Chief Justice Surya Kant and Justices Joymalya Bagchi and V Mohana asked the Centre to consider setting up regional and circuit benches of the national consumer forum, saying a consumer must not be made to travel all the way to Delhi, instead, the forum



must go to them. The bench asked the chairman of the NCDRC to furnish a status report on total pending cases, total complaints filed, average rate of disposal of cases, estimated time likely for disposal of a pending case and need for increasing the strength of members of the commission.

The top court, which is monitoring the functioning of consumer commissions, including appointments, service conditions and infrastructure, said the report must be filed in two weeks.

The top court was informed that pendency of case is huge in NCDRC as the matters which are being taken up for hearing at present are from 2018-19.

While some lawyers informed the bench that if a matter is listed in June this year, then the next date of listing of the matter is almost next year while others said that 30-40 matters are normally listed in post-lunch session, which does not get disposed of.

The bench then told Additional Solicitor General Aishwarya Bhati, appearing for Centre in the matter that if the arrears are piling up in the NCDRC, then the only option left is to increase the maximum strength of the commission. "We have a consumer friendly jurisprudence and pendency of cases can be reduced by increasing the number of benches," CJI Kant said.

Dismiss CBI's challenge to discharge in excise case: Kejriwal, Sisodia to Delhi HC

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

AAP leaders Arvind Kejriwal and Manish Sisodia on Monday urged the Delhi High Court to dismiss the CBI's petition challenging their discharge in the liquor policy case, stating that it was filed with "unprecedented haste" and in the "most unserious manner".

In separate applications, the former Delhi chief minister and his deputy assailed the maintainability of the CBI's revision petition, and said they have been unable to discern the agency's case against them in the "bare-shell" and "non-specific" petition.

"The CBI has preferred the present revision petition with unprecedented haste and in the most unserious manner. The present revision petition was filed only within four hours of passing of the order of discharge by



the Ld. Special Judge, which manifestly shows non-appreciation of the findings of the Ld. Special Judge in the discharge judgement running into more than 500 pages," the application stated.

"Thus, if such a petition is held to be maintainable, a grave prejudice will be caused to the respondent herein," it added.

Justice Manoj Jain is scheduled to hear on August 17 and 18 the CBI's petition assailing the trial court's

February 27 decision. On the last occasion, Justice Jain had granted a final opportunity to Kejriwal, Sisodia and Durgesh Pathak to respond to the plea within two weeks.

In the latest applications, Kejriwal and Sisodia asserted that the trial court discharged all accused persons after hearing the matter in detail for more than three months, but the CBI has not pointed out any specific finding that is "perverse" or

shows any irregularity. Claiming that the agency has merely pointed out "self-serving facts", they also claimed that the petition does not specifically state how the discharge of each accused was done without appreciating the evidence.

"The present petition is incomplete as it is without the material being relied upon and the specific averments in the order of discharge- hence it is liable to be dismissed in its present form..It is clear from the present petition filed by the CBI that not a single paragraph out of 1133 paragraphs of the discharge judgment is referred by CBI to suggest the perversity in the order," the application stated.

Kejriwal and Sisodia also emphasised that jurisdiction of the high court in the present case was limited and could be exercised cautiously, only in cases of grave perversity.

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1 in every 7 food orders now comes from 99 Store: Swiggy

Food delivery aggregator Swiggy on Thursday said it has witnessed remarkable growth in the affordability-led offering '99 Store' since its launch a year ago, with the platform accounting for one in every seven orders through the disruptive offering.

In the last one year, 99 Store has expanded to over 500 cities with an extensive network of over 1.8 lakh restaurant partners. 99 Store has a dedicated section within the Swiggy Food app. While it offers food across categories, the most popular food choices on 99 Store include Bowls and Thalys, South Indian Breakfast, Burgers and American food, Pizzas, Beverages, Chaats and other snacks. Sidharth Bhakoo, Chief Business Officer, Swiggy Food Marketplace, said, "The response over the last year has been phenomenal, with monthly orders growing 2.4x over the last year. Looking ahead, we are committed to expanding our partner network and bringing an even wider assortment of choices to our 99 Store customers."

AISATS offers jobs to armed forces dependents

Airport services provider AISATS plans to offer more jobs to Veer Naris, widows and wards of deceased armed forces personnel as it inducted the first batch of such people on Thursday.

Air India SATS Airport Services Pvt Ltd (AISATS) is an equal joint venture between Air India and Singapore's SATS. The first batch of 10 candidates will start working for AISATS at the Delhi airport. They will be deployed across key airport functions, including customer service executives, load control agents, cargo service agents and ramp agents, the company said on Thursday.

The recruitment has been done through its partnership with the Indian Army and the Army Welfare Placement Office (AWPO). At a briefing in the national capital, AISATS Chief Human Resources Officer said 46 more people have been shortlisted for recruitment through the partnership and that it would explore more opportunities.

"Veer Naris, widows and their wards have made extraordinary sacrifices for the nation, and while those sacrifices can never truly be repaid, we hope this initiative helps create opportunities for financial independence, professional growth, and a brighter future," he said.

Gold, silver imports soften in July

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE ■ New Delhi

India's gold and silver imports softened in July following a sharp increase in customs duty on these precious metals, according to data released by the commerce ministry.

While gold imports rose by only 4.77 per cent to \$4.16 billion, silver imports dipped 66.1 per cent to \$171.68 million in July, the data showed. The Government has increased import duty on precious metals from 6 per cent to 15 per cent effective May 13.

Prices of the yellow metal were hovering around ₹1,57,000 per 10 grams (inclusive of all taxes) in the national capital on Thursday. Silver was priced at around ₹2.40 lakh per Kg.

Cumulatively during April-

accelerate industrial growth, generate employment, enhance technological capabilities, strengthen self-reliance, and expand its presence in international markets.

Together, these sectors capture the breadth of India's manufacturing opportunity: from employment-intensive industries and foundational industrial inputs to advanced technology products and strategic sectors of the future, it added.

The report noted that a common theme emerging across all four sectors is that India possesses significant inherent advantages, includ-

The Pioneer

NEW DELHI | FRIDAY | AUGUST 14, 2026

India, US continuing trade talks: Commerce Secretary

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE ■ New Delhi

India is in 'regular contact' with the US for negotiating the proposed bilateral trade agreement (BTA), Commerce Secretary Rajesh Agarwal said on Thursday.

He said that both sides are committed to the framework deal that was agreed upon in February.

In February, both sides finalised contours for the first phase of the BTA.

However, changes in the tariff landscape in the US have led to further negotiations on the agreement between the two countries.

At present, the US has imposed an additional 10 per cent duty on Indian goods under a Section 301 probe on alleged forced labour concerns.

"We are engaged with the US side on the trade deal and our contacts are regular," Agarwal told reporters here.

On the issue of the USA's Russian oil tariff bill, the secretary declined to comment, saying it is a legislative process of the US, which is

Commerce Secretary Rajesh Agarwal

underway and is their internal process.

Earlier this month, the US Senate voted overwhelmingly to approve a bill to punish Russia and key buyers of its petroleum products, such as China and India, claiming that such trade helps fuel the Ukraine war.

This bill will allow US President Donald Trump to impose 100 per cent tariffs on goods from countries that are the top five importers of Russian oil and gas.

He said that a key outcome of a trade deal is that it brings in more stability and pre-

dictability in the trade relationship so that businesses can work along.

The commerce ministry said that India continues to actively engage with US authorities to resolve outstanding trade issues while working toward the early conclusion of the India-US BTA. On the bill, a source said that it is a matter of concern, but India is closely following developments and remains in touch with the US side at various levels and talks with them as reassuring.

The source also said that it is misleading and factually

incorrect to link the reforms in UPI to India-US trade discussions.

Recently, Commerce and Industry Minister Piyush Goyal has said that the first tranche of the bilateral trade agreement between India and the US will come into operation as soon as the United States is able to ensure that India gets a comparative advantage over its competitors.

The US has imposed an additional 10 per cent tariff on a number of countries, including India, from July 24. Countries, including Sri Lanka, Bangladesh, Thailand, Cambodia, Vietnam, Indonesia and Malaysia, are major competitors of India in the US market.

Tariff advantage vis-a-vis these nations will give price competitiveness to Indian goods in the American market. India exported goods worth about \$87 billion to the US in 2025-26. Goyal and USTR Jamieson Greer held bilateral talks in June on issues related to the first phase of the agreement.

Sensex up nearly 114 pts, Nifty ends below 24,400

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE ■ Mumbai

Benchmark indices ended mixed on Thursday, with the Sensex rising nearly 114 points and the Nifty sliding over 40 points, as elevated crude prices and geopolitical uncertainty made investors cautious.

Fag-end buying helped the BSE Sensex to end the session in positive territory. The 30-share index settled 113.61 points, or 0.15 per cent, higher at 78,079.96. During the day, the benchmark hit a high of 78,119.39 and a low of 77,665.89, gyrating 453.5 points.

The 50-share NSE Nifty was marginally down 40.10

Index	Open	High	Low	Close	Change
NSE NIFTY	24,431.60	24,435.95	24,311.40	24,395.85	-40.10 (-0.16%)
BSE SENSEX	78,111.91	78,119.39	77,966.35	78,079.96	+113.61 (0.15%)

points, or 0.16 per cent, to end at 24,395.85, registering its third day of decline.

From the Sensex pack, InterGlobe Aviation, NTPC,

Bharat Electronics, Larsen & Toubro, Hindustan Unilever and Eternal were among the winners. ICICI Bank, Titan, Reliance

Rupee falls 12 paise to close at 95.45 against US dollar

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE ■ Mumbai

The rupee depreciated 12 paise to 95.45 against the US dollar on Thursday, weighed by weak domestic markets and persistent foreign fund outflows amid lingering geopolitical risks.

Forex traders said investor sentiment remains fragile on the delay in the deal between the US and Iran and the broad strength of the American currency in the overseas markets.

At the interbank foreign exchange, the rupee opened at 95.40 against the greenback and traded in a range of 95.35-95.48 during the session. It eventually settled at 95.45 (provisional), lower by 12 paise from its previous close.

On Wednesday, the rupee settled just 3 paise higher at 95.33 against the US dollar. "We expect the rupee to trade

Date	Rate (INR/USD)	Change
Aug 6	95.22	(-14p)
Aug 7	95.17	(+5p)
Aug 10	95.30	(-13p)
Aug 11	95.36	(-6p)
Aug 12	95.33	(+3p)
Aug 13	95.45*	(-12p)

with a slight negative bias on the delay in the deal between the US and Iran and a strong dollar. However, renewed hopes of talks and softening

of crude oil prices may support the rupee at lower levels.

"Any intervention by the RBI may also support the rupee at lower levels. Traders may take cues from US PPI inflation and weekly unemployment claims data. USD-INR spot price is expected to trade in a range of 95.20 to 95.70," said Anuj Choudhary, Research Analyst, Mirae Asset ShareKhan.

On the domestic macroeconomic front, retail inflation inched up to 4.45 per cent in July on expensive kitchen staples, including onion and ginger, even as the price rise remained above the Reserve Bank's median target for the second consecutive month. Meanwhile, the dollar index, which gauges the greenback's strength against a basket of six currencies, was trading at 99.89, down 0.11 per cent.

BUSINESS

11

'EXPORTS TO WEST ASIA REGION RISE 8.62% IN JULY'

New Delhi: India's exports to the West Asian region rose by 8.62 per cent year-on-year to \$5.7 billion in July, despite global uncertainties, Commerce Secretary Rajesh Agrawal said on Thursday. Exports to the West Asian countries stood at \$5.2 billion in the same month last year, as per the Government data.

The shipments to the region had declined for the first time in March due to the US-Iran conflict, but improved in April and further in May and June.

Agrawal said that trade is back to earlier levels with this region. The country's exports to the UAE rose 10.15 per cent to \$3.3 billion, but shipments to Saudi Arabia declined by 2.73 per cent year-on-year to \$763.7 million.

Imports from the UAE and Saudi Arabia dipped during the last month. However, imports from Oman more than doubled to \$1.57 billion. Indian

exporters are using three ports (Duqm, Sohar and Salalah) in Oman, and the Port of Fujairah and Khor Fakkan Port in the UAE to push exports to the region.

Earlier, the Port of Jebel Ali in the United Arab Emirates used to handle a lot of cargoes for that region, but it has faced operational disruptions due to the ongoing crisis.

The US-Iran war has impacted the movement of ships carrying cargoes in international waters, particularly through the Strait of Hormuz. India normally exports goods worth about \$6 billion every month to the region.

INDIA-SACU PTA When asked why India has shifted its focus in trade negotiations from developed countries to the SACU group, the secretary said the world is increasingly integrating with the African continent, and India is starting with a preferential trade agreement (PTA). (PNS)

L&T bags mega order for India's largest AI facility

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE ■ New Delhi

Infrastructure major Larsen & Toubro (L&T) on Thursday said it has secured an order ranging between ₹10,000 and ₹15,000 crore to build the country's largest single-cluster Artificial Intelligence (AI) infrastructure facility, marking the company's foray into the AI Factory business.

Through its AI infrastructure arm, LTN Compute, and L&T's AI and data centre business, Vyoma.AI, L&T will set up an NVIDIA B300-based AI Factory at its Chennai data centre campus to power the AI-native cloud platform of the US-based Together AI.

The AI Factory will power the AI-native cloud platform for large-scale inference, fine-tuning and training workloads, strengthening India's AI infrastructure ecosystem while supporting global innovation, L&T said in a statement.

L&T has not revealed the exact value of the order.

However, under its order classification, a 'mega order' ranges between ₹10,000 and ₹15,000 crore.

Vyoma's Chennai data centre campus, conceived as a gigawatt-scale AI infrastructure site, has been designed with Phase 1 capacity of 250 MW and power infrastructure readiness of 150 MVA, laying a scalable foundation for future AI Factory expansion.

The integrated AI Factory, with a capacity of 10,000 NVIDIA B300 GPUs, will be hosted at Vyoma's Chennai data centre, the statement added.

The platform combines hyperscale data centre infrastructure, accelerated computing, high-performance networking, ultra-low-latency interconnects, high-throughput parallel storage and AI infrastructure operations, enabling customers to seamlessly deploy and scale AI workloads through a unified, end-to-end AI infrastructure stack.

Majority of Tata stocks rebound after Chandra's exit

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE ■ New Delhi

The majority of the Tata Group stocks bounced back on Thursday after falling in the previous trade following the announcement by N Chandrasekaran that he will step down as chairman of Tata Sons when his current term ends on February 20, 2027.

Shares of Tata Technologies jumped 3.26 per cent, Tata Consumer Products climbed 2.74 per cent, Tata Motors Passenger Vehicles advanced 1.68 per

Tata Sons Chairman N Chandrasekaran leaves Bombay House in Mumbai, Maharashtra on Thursday

cent, Tata Elxsi was up 1.36 per cent, and Tata Communications edged higher by 1.28 per cent. Trent

moved up 1.08 per cent, TCS rallied 0.99 per cent, Tata Power (0.53 per cent), Indian Hotels Company (0.42 per

"Addressing these bottlenecks will require a coordinated approach involving the Union and state governments, industry, academia, financial institutions, and the

broader innovation ecosystem," it said.

The Aayog noted that sectoral analyses also reinforce the importance of moving beyond assembly-led or low-

value manufacturing towards deeper and more resilient value-chain participation.

In chemicals, the priority lies in strengthening domestic feedstock availability, developing integrated manufacturing clusters, and increasing downstream value addition, it added.

Noting that the experiences of global manufacturing leaders examined in this report further highlight that sustained success is rarely the result of a single policy intervention, the Aayog said that, rather, it is achieved through long-term policy consistency, industrial clustering, infrastructure readiness, targeted incentives,

investment in technology and skills, and strong linkages between domestic firms and global markets.

Releasing the report, Niti Aayog Vice Chairman Ashok Kumar Lahiri said: "India stands at a defining moment in its economic and industrial journey. As the nation moves forward with the vision of Viksit Bharat @2047, manufacturing will play a central role in shaping the country's future growth trajectory".

Across the world, Lahiri said the experience of every major industrial economy has demonstrated that sustained economic transfor-

mation is built on a strong and globally competitive manufacturing base.

He said manufacturing not only drives investment, innovation and exports, but also creates quality employment, raises productivity and strengthens linkages across multiple sectors of the economy.

For a country like India, Lahiri said, with a young workforce and a median age of around 28 years, a vibrant manufacturing sector offers the most effective pathway to harnessing its demographic dividend and translating it into broad-based and inclusive prosperity.

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Statement of Standalone Unaudited Financial Results for the Quarter Ended June 30, 2026					
(Rupees in lakhs)					
Sl.No.	Particulars	For the Quarter Ended June 30, 2026	For the Quarter Ended Mar 31, 2026	For the Quarter Ended June 30, 2025	For the Year Ended March 31, 2026
		(Unaudited)	(Audited)	(Unaudited)	(Audited)
1	Total Income from operations	4,247.52	2,207.50	4,207.28	11,361.35
2	Net Profit / (Loss) for the period (before Tax, Exceptional and/or Extraordinary items)	1,186.46	136.77	617.93	1,077.14
3	Net Profit / (Loss) for the period before tax (after Exceptional and/or Extraordinary items)	1,186.46	136.37	617.93	1,076.74
4	Net Profit / (Loss) for the period after tax (after Exceptional and/or Extraordinary items)	990.51	147.45	463.90	848.25
5	Total Comprehensive Income for the period [Comprising Profit / (Loss) for the period (after tax) and Other Comprehensive Income (after tax)]	990.51	147.45	463.90	848.25
6	Paid Up Equity Share Capital	1,593.23	1,593.23	1,593.23	1,593.23
7	Reserves (excluding Revaluation Reserve) as shown in the Audited Balance Sheet of the previous year	-	7,894.51	-	7,894.51
8	Securities Premium Account	558.65	558.65	558.65	558.65
9	Net Worth	10,478.25	9,487.74	9,103.38	9,487.74
10	Paid up Debt Capital / Outstanding Debt	0.27	0.29	0.27	0.29
11	Outstanding Redeemable Perferences Shares	-	-	-	-
12	Debt Equity Ratio	0.56	0.59	0.64	0.59
13	Earnings Per Share (of Rs. 10/- each) (before and after extraordinary items)	-	-	-	-
	1. Basic:	6.22	0.93	2.91	5.32
	2. Diluted:	6.22	0.93	2.91	5.32
14	Capital Redemption Reserve	-	-	-	-
15	Debtenture Redemption Reserve	-	-	-	-
16	Debt Service Coverage Ratio	6.83	1.17	2.26	1.49
17	Interest Service coverage Ratio	13.63	2.50	5.61	3.59

Note:

The above standalone financial result for the quater ended June 30, 2026 are prepared in accordance with the Indian Accounting Standrand (IND-AS) as prescribed under Section 133 of the Companies Act, 2013 read with rule 3 of the Companies (Indian Accounting Standards) Rules, 2015 and Companies (Indian Accounting Standards) Amendment Rules, 2016.
The above is an extract of the detailed format of Quarterly Financial Results filed with the Bombay Stock Exchange under Regulation 33 of the SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015. The full format of the Quarterly Financial Results are as on June 30, 2026 are available on the websites of the Bombay Stock Exchange i.e. www.bseindia.in and on web site of the Company i.e. www.ashnoortex.com

By Order of the Board of Directors
For Ashnoor Textile Mills Limited

Sd/-
Suneel Gupta
Managing Director
DIN - 00052084

Place : Gurugram, Haryana
Date : 12/08/2026

THE KANGRA CO-OPERATIVE BANK LTD.
C-29, Community Centre Pankha Road, Janakpuri, New Delhi-110058
Phone: 011-25611042, 25611043, 25611044
E-mail: legal@kangrabank.com, legal1@kangrabank.com, Website: www.kangrabank.com

[APPENDIX IV-A] [See proviso to rule 8 (6)]

E-AUCTION SALE NOTICE FOR SALE OF IMMOVABLE PROPERTY
E-Auction Sale Notice for Sale of below mentioned Immovable Secured Asset Under The Securitisation and Reconstruction of the Financial Assets & Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002, read with proviso to rule 8 (6) of The Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002.
Notice is hereby given to the Public in General and in particular to the below mentioned borrower, Co-mortgagor & Legal heir of Co-mortgagor & Surety that the below described immovable property mortgaged/charged to The Secured Creditor, the physical possession of which has been taken by the Authorised officer of The Secured Creditor, will be sold on "AS IS WHERE IS", "AS IS WHAT IS" AND "WHATEVER THERE IS" BASIS THROUGH "SALE BY e-auction (under SARFAESI Act & Rules, 2002)" as per brief particulars given hereunder:-

Sr. No.	a) Name of Borrower & Surety b) Branch Name	(a) Date of Demand Notice (b) Possession Type/Date, Demand Notice Amount.	Description of Property.	Reserve Price	(a) Earnest Money Deposit. (b) Bid Increment amount. (c) Date & Time of Inspection. (a) Last date/Time of EMD & KYC Submission. Last/ Time of E-Auction.
1.	Smt. Jyoti Bajwa W/o. Sh. Late Sh. Ajay Bajwa, JP17/946 (50683) JK Loan account no. 00028110006711, 00028110006736, 00028070008598, (Borrower, Co-Mortgagor & Legal Heir of Co-Mortgagor & Surety) Sh. Sahil Bajwa Sh. Late Sh. Ajay Bajwa (Legal Heir of Co-Mortgagor & Surety) Branch Jagatpuri	(a) 13-10-2023 (b) Physical/02-08-2024. (c) Rs.17,11,814/- together with further interest, penal interest and other charges as are applicable in the Loan account from time to time, from 30-09-2023 till the date of payment.	BUILT UP SHOP ON GROUND FLOOR, UPTO CEILING LEVEL, WITH ALL FIXTURES AND FITTINGS FITTED THEREON, WITH CONNECTION OF ELECTRICITY IN RUNNING CONDITION WITH METER, TOGETHER WITH PROPORTIONATE, UNDIVIDED OWNERSHIP RIGHTS OF THE LAND THEREUNDER, BUILT ON PORTION OF PROPERTY BEARING NO.A-7/28, MEASURING AREA OF PLOT 14.86-SQ.MTRS., (8 X 20') HAVING ITS PLINTH COVERED AREA 14.86-SQ.MTRS., SITUATED IN THE ABADI OF DLF COLONY KNOWN AS KRISHAN NAGAR, IN THE AREA OF VILLAGE GHONDLI, ILAQA SHAHDARA, DELHI-110051 AND BOUNDED AS EAST : GALL, WEST : PORTION OF THE SAID PROPERTY, NORTH : PROPERTY OF OTHERS, SOUTH : SHOP OF OTHERS BUILT ON PORTION OF THE SAID PROPERTY.	Rupees Seventeen Lakhs Fifty Thousand Only (Rs. 17,50,000/-)	(a) Rs.1,75,000/- (b) Rs.10,000/- (c) 29-08-2026 11.00 am. To 4.00 p.m., (d) 02-09-2026 upto 5:30 p.m. (e) 04-09-2026, 3:00 p.m. To 5:00 p.m.

For detailed Bid/Tender form, terms and conditions of the said sale, please refer to the link provided in THE KANGRA CO-OPERATIVE BANK LTD., HEAD OFFICE AT C-29, COMMUNITY CENTRE, PANKHA ROAD, JANAKPURI, NEAR JANAK CINEMA, NEW DELHI-110058. The Secured Creditor Bank's website, i.e., www.kangrabank.com.
The auction will be conducted through the Bank's approved service provider M/s. e-Procurement Technologies Limited (Auction Tiger), and for detailed Bid/Tender form, terms and conditions of the said sale and procedure of submission of Bid/Tender, are available from their website at https://sarfaesi.auctiontiger.net

STATUTORY NOTICE AS PER RULE 8(6) & RULE 9 (1) OF SARFAESI ACT 2002
This notice also is considered as a notice to the above named borrower/mortgagor of said loan, to pay the dues in full before the date of sale, failing which the property will be sold on the above mentioned Sale/Auction date. This publication is also 15 day's notice to the above named borrower & mortgagor.

HARISH SHARMA
AUTHORISED OFFICER
THE KANGRA CO-OPERATIVE BANK LTD.
HEAD OFFICE AT C-29, COMMUNITY CENTRE, PANKHA ROAD, JANAKPURI, NEW DELHI-110058, PHONE NO. 9013568418, 9013568419.

DATED: 12-08-2026
PLACE : DELHI

SVC CO-OPERATIVE BANK LTD.
NUN SE MAI POSSIBLE
Corporate Office: SVC Tower, Nehru Road, Vokola, Santacruz(E), Mumbai-400 055
Having one of its Branch: No.666, 12th Main, 3rd Block, Rajaji Nagar, Bangalore - 560 010
Having its Regional Office-1 : No.27, Mount Joy Road, Hanumanthnagar, Bangalore-560 019
PH: 080 26603994/995

POSSESSION NOTICE

WHEREAS the undersigned being the Authorised Officer of SVC CO-OPERATIVE BANK LTD. (Formerly The Shamrao Vitthal Co-op. Bank Ltd.,) a Co-operative Bank, registered under the Co-operative Credit Societies Act (X of 1904) and registered under the Multi State Co-operative Societies Act, 2002, under The Securitization & Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act 2002 as amended by The Enforcement of Security Interest and Recovery of Debts Laws (Amdt.) Act, 2016 (44 of 2016) and further amended by the security interest (Enforcement) (Amendment) Rules 2018 & in exercise of powers conferred under Section 13 (12) read with Rule 3 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002 issued Demand Notice dated 21-05-2026 and the same was published in The New Indian Express and Kannada Prabha Daily Newspapers (Bangalore Edition) on 02-06-2026 and The Pioneer and Nodaya Times (English and Hindi Delhi edition) calling upon the Borrower Mr. Rahul Kumar, H.No. RZD 1/139, Gali Number 5, Palam Enclave, Palam Village, Southwest, Delhi - 110045 & Builder/Developer S. V. Gayatri Devi Talatam, Flat no B-303 Jampa delight 4th T Cross, South Kalena Agrahara, MLA Layout Bannerghatta Road, Bangalore to repay the total amount due mentioned in the said notice being Rs.72,34,867.64 (Rupees Seventy Two Lakh Thirty Four Thousand Eight Hundred Sixty Seven and paise Sixty Four Only) as on 22-04-2026 together with interest thereon and cost from 23-04-2026 until the date of payment within 60 days from the date of the said Notice.
The Borrower/Builder/Developer mentioned herein above having failed to repay the entire amount, notice is hereby given to the Borrower/Builder/Developer mentioned herein above in particular and to the public in general that the undersigned Authorized Officer has taken PHYSICAL POSSESSION of the property described herein below in exercise of powers conferred on him under Section 13 (4) of the said Act read with the Rule 8 of the said Rules on this day, the 11th day of August 2026.
The Borrower/Builder/Developer owner mentioned herein above in particular and the public in general are hereby cautioned not to deal with the property and any dealings with the property will be subject to the charge of SVC Co-operative Bank Ltd., for an amount of Rs.73,85,615.64 (Rupees Seventy Three Lakhs Eighty Five Thousand Six Hundred Fifteen and Paise Sixty Four Only) as on 19-07-2026 together with interest thereon and cost from 20-07-2026 until the date of payment.
The Borrowers attention is invited to sub-section (8) of Section 13 in respect of time available to redeem the Secured Assets.

DESCRIPTION OF THE PROPERTY

SCHEDULE "A" PROPERTY: (Description of the entire land Area)
ALL THAT PIECE AND PARCEL of the property bearing Site No.79A, layout shown as "Kammanahally village-Bannerghatta Road Layout", formed by the Central Excise House Building Co-operative Society Ltd., Bangalore, situated at KAMMANAHALLY VILLAGE, Bannerghatta road, Begur Hobli, Bangalore South, formed in Sy. Nos. 126/1, 126/2, 126/3, 126/3-1, 127, 128/2, 3 and 4 and 131/3, and coming under the limits of Bruhath Bangalore Mahanagara Palike, Ward No.192-Begur, Bangalore, measuring East to West-60'-0" ft., and North to South-41'-0" ft., totally measuring 2460 sq.ft., and bounded as East by: Site No.95A, West by: Road, North by: Site No.79 & South by: Private Property.
SCHEDULE "B" PROPERTY: (undivided share on which security interest is created)
307 Sq.ft. of Undivided Share, right, title and interest in the Schedule "A" Property.
SCHEDULE "C" PROPERTY: (Flat on which security interest is created)
ALL THAT PIECE AND PARCEL of the Flat bearing No. 202, Second Floor, of the building known as "ZURICH CHALET" constructed on the Schedule A Property, having a super built-up Area measuring 1050 square feet, having RCC Roofing, vitrified Tiles Floors, Sal Wood Doors & Aluminium windows, and Separate Electricity connections, Common Water and Sanitation, including common area rights with One Covered Car parking slot in still floor, and including all rights, privileges, appurtenances thereto and Bounded as East by: Flat No. 201, West by: Set Back, North by: Corridor & South by: Set Back.
(Mr. SARATHY SOMIAH)
AUTHORIZED OFFICER
& ASSISTANT GENERAL MANAGER
L&R, SOUTH REGION.

Date : 12-08-2026
Place : BENGALURU

Ukraine's drones hit major Russian refinery: Officials

ILLIA NOVIKOV ■ Kyiv

Ukrainian drones struck a major refinery deep inside Russia, military officials said on Thursday, the fourth in three days in Kyiv's monthslong campaign to choke Moscow's vital oil sector.

Russia is one of the world's biggest energy producers, with oil providing an economic mainstay as its army tries to push deeper into Ukraine in a slow and costly advance more than four years after Moscow launched its full-scale invasion.

The attacks have dented Russia's refining capacity, bringing shortages at gas stations. Kyiv officials say the onslaught seeks to compel Russian President Vladimir Putin to seek a peace deal. There is no sign that strategy is working. Ukraine's General Staff said its forces struck the Gazprom Neftekhim Salavat oil refining and petrochemical complex in Russia's republic of Bashkortostan overnight, causing a fire at the facility.

The complex, located southeast of Moscow about 1,300 km from Ukraine's border, is one of Russia's largest oil refining and petrochemical facilities, the General Staff said in a Telegram post. The plant processes up to 74 million barrels of oil annually, producing gasoline, diesel fuel and other products, it said. Russia's Bashkortostan governor, Radiy Khabirov, said only that a drone attack wounded two civilians and started a fire in an industrial zone of Salavat.

Wildberries, Russia's biggest online retailer whose giant warehouses have repeatedly been struck by Ukrainian drones, said a fire started at one of its facilities in the Salavat industrial zone after the overnight attack. The company said the facility was evacuated but that

goods were not being stored there.

The attack came a day after Ukrainian anti-ship missiles and drones blitzed a major Russian naval base on the Black Sea coast.

Elsewhere, four explosive experts from Russia's Emergency Ministry and a security guard were killed Thursday after an unspecified Ukrainian weapon exploded in Sevastopol, a port city in illegally annexed Crimea, the Russian-installed governor of Sevastopol Mikhail Razvozhayev said.

They were inspecting the site of a Ukrainian attack when "an enemy weapon detonated", he said. It was not possible to independently verify either side's reports. Meanwhile, a Russian refinery in Orsk that was hit by Ukrainian drones earlier this week has suspended operations, Orenburg region Governor Yevgeny Solntsev said on Thursday. He said that "key infrastructure, which cannot be restored at

this time" was struck, including foreign equipment, and "taking (international) sanctions into account," the repairs could take up to six months, Solntsev said in a rare public admission in Russia of the problems Ukrainian attacks are causing.

Ukraine's General Staff had reported striking the Orsk refinery, in Russia's Orenburg region near the border with Kazakhstan, on Tuesday. Russia has responded by hammering Ukraine with ballistic missiles, jet-powered drones and glide bombs, all of which are powerful and hard to intercept. The strikes have killed more than 16,000 civilians since the war began, according to the United Nations.

Russian attacks featuring 133 long-range strike drones killed at least four people and wounded eight others across Ukraine overnight from Wednesday to on Thursday, officials said. (AP)

Taliban detains six staff of human right group

ASSOCIATED PRESS ■ Ankara

Afghanistan's Taliban authorities have "forcibly disappeared" six staff members of a local organisation working on women's and children's rights, a US-based advocacy group said, following a separate UN report that two Afghan employees of its mission in the country were detained.

The reported detentions come as Afghanistan's Taliban rulers prepare to mark the fifth anniversary of their return to power on Saturday.

The six men — employees of the Women and Children Legal Research Foundation - were detained after they were told to come to their office to retrieve confiscated laptops and phones, Human Rights Watch said.

PUBLIC NOTICE

It is to inform to the public at large that Mrs. Savita had acquired Residential Part of House No-5298, measuring 50 sq. yds., Kharsa No-369 Min, situated at Village Sahibabad Pargana Loni Tehsil Ghaziabad, U.P. vide Sale Deed dt. 26.04.2019 executed by Mrs. Saroj Sharma. Original Sale deed dt. 14.05.1975 & Original Sale deed dt. 21.04.1998 w.r.t. said property is lost. Now Mrs. Savita is the undisputed owner of above said property and willing to Mortgage the above said property with CIPCL.

OR
Any person / firm / institution / company having any claim or right in respect of the said Property by way of inheritance, share, sale, agreement, lease, license, gift, possession, legal heirs, partners or encumbrance howsoever or otherwise is hereby requested to intimate in writing to the undersigned within 07 days from the date of publication of this notice of his/her their share or claim, if any, with all supporting documents at below mentioned address. After expiration of notice period, the claims, if any, of such person shall be treated null and void and also treated as waived and not binding on our client.
Ajay Kumar Gili (Advocate) H No. 26/161, Basement, Vikram Vihar, Lalpat Nagar 4, New Delhi - 110024

PUBLIC NOTICE

Notice is hereby given to the public at large that my client proposes to acquire GDB REAL ESTATE DEVELOPERS PRIVATE LIMITED, CIN U70101DL1997PTC087187, having its Registered Office at 216-B, UIG DDA Flat, Jhilmil Colony, East Delhi-110092 ("Target Company") together with its assets, liabilities, under takings, title and properties, including land situated at Village Shimli, Tehsil Ramnagar, District Nainital, bearing Kharsa Nos. 728A Min, 738A, 106, 135Aa, 136, 137, 138Min, 139, 140, 141, 142, 143Min, 146, 157Ba, 206Ba, 211Sa, 214Va, 214Aa, 215Sa, 215Va, 217, 218Ba, 219, 220, 221, 222, 222Sa, 223, 226, 227, 228, 231, 232Min, 233Va, 233Aa, 235Aa, 236Aa, 236Va, 237, 238Sa, 238Ba, 239, 241Min, 242, 243, 244, 245, 246Aa, 247, 248, 249Sa, 249Va, 250, 251Min, 252Va, 252Aa, 253, 254Ba, 254Aa, 255Aa, 255Va, 257, 258, 259, 260Aa, 260Va and 262Aa.

Any person / entity having any claim, objection, right, title, interest, mortgage, charge, lien, lease, easement, trust or encumbrance in respect of the Target Company, its shareholding, assets or the aforesaid property is requested to intimate the same in writing, along with supporting documents, to the undersigned within 14 days from publication of this notice.
In the absence of any such claim / objection within the aforesaid period, the Acquirer shall proceed with the proposed acquisition without reference to any such claim or objection.

Through Counsel Place: New Delhi
MIHIR GUJJUJEWAR (ADVOCATE)
Email: adv.mihirgjujwar@yahoo.com

BNP nominates Mirza Fakhrul Islam as Bangladesh President

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA ■ Dhaka

The ruling Bangladesh Nationalist Party (BNP) on Thursday nominated its secretary general Mirza Fakhrul Islam Alamgir as its candidate for the country's presidency, setting the stage for his election as the next head of State.

The presidential election will be held on August 20.

The 78-year-old veteran politician resigned as BNP secretary general and from its highest policy-making standing committee after being nominated, senior joint secretary general Ruhul Kabir Rizvi announced. "It is with great pleasure that I announce on behalf of the Bangladesh Nationalist Party that our dedicated secretary general, Mirza Fakhrul Islam Alamgir, has become the BNP's presidential candidate," he said. The nomination was announced after a meeting of senior BNP leaders with Prime Minister Tarique Rahman, who is also the party chairman, at the Prime Minister's Secretariat.

Under the Election Commission's schedule, Alamgir was required to submit his nomination papers by 4:00 pm on Thursday. Bangladesh's main opposition Jamaat-e-Islami has also fielded the party-led alliance partner Liberal Democratic Party (LDP) Chairman Colonel (retd) Oli Ahmad. Ahmad has already submitted his nomination papers to the

Election Commission.

The presidential election comes after former president Mohammed Shahabuddin resigned on July 24, citing serious health problems, about two years before the end of his term. He was a longtime ally of deposed prime minister Sheikh Hasina. Under the Constitution, a new president is required to be elected within 90 days of the office falling vacant.

Parliamentary Speaker Hafiz Uddin Ahmad is currently serving as acting president, as required under the Constitution following a vacancy in the office. The Constitution provides for the president to be elected by Parliament. The BNP, which was voted to power in the February 12 elections, currently commands a two-thirds majority in Parliament, putting Alamgir in a strong position to secure the presidency.

SVAM AGRITECH LIMITED
(Formerly known as Svam Software Limited)
CIN : L65100DL1992PLC047327

Registered Office: 224, G/F, Swayam Sewa, Co-Operative Housing Society Ltd., Jhilmil, Delhi-110 032
Corporate Office: Office No. 514, Clifton Corporate Park, AB Road, Vijay Nagar, Indore, Madhya Pradesh-452 010

Extract of Unaudited Financial Results for the Quarter ended 30/06/2026 (Rs. In Lakhs except EPS)

Sr. No.	Particulars	Quarter Ending 30/06/2026	Year to Date Figures 31/03/2026	Corresponding Three Months Ended in Previous Year 30.06.2025
01	Total Income from Operations	52.47	79.43	9.99
02	Net Profit / (Loss) for the period (before Tax, Exceptional and / or Extraordinary Items)	-19.15	12.72	1.04
03	Net Profit / (Loss) for the period (before Tax after Exceptional and / or Extraordinary items)	-19.15	12.72	1.04
04	Net Profit / (Loss) for the period (after Tax, Exceptional and / or Extraordinary items)	-19.15	9.07	1.04
05	Total Comprehensive Income for the Period [Comprising Profit / (Loss) for the period (after Tax) and Other Comprehensive Income (after Tax)]	-19.15	9.07	1.04
06	Equity Share Capital	1688.90	1688.90	1688.90
07	Reserves & Surplus (excluding Revaluation Reserve) as shown in the Audited Balance Sheet of the previous year.	0.00	0.00	0.00
08	Face Value of Equity Share Capital	10	10	10
09	Earnings Per Share (Basic)	-0.11	0.05	0.01
10	Earnings Per Share (Diluted)	-0.11	0.05	0.01

Note: The above is an extract of the detailed format of Quarterly Financial Results filed with the Stock Exchanges under Regulation 33 of the SEBI (LODR) Regulations, 2015. The full format of the Quarterly Financial Results are available on the Stock Exchange website i.e. www.bseindia.com

For, Svam Software Limited,
SD/- Harish Kumar Sharma • Managing Director - DIN: 10785775

Date : 12/08/2026
Place : Ahmedabad

यूनियन बैंक ऑफ इंडिया
भारत सरकार का उपक्रम
A Government of India Undertaking

Regional Office New Delhi First Floor, 1, Faiz Road, Jhandewalan, New Delhi-110005
Email Id: law.ronewdelhi@unionbankofindia.bank.in
crld.ronewdelhi@unionbankofindia.bank.in

SALE NOTICE for Sale of Immovable Properties

E-Auction Sale Notice for Sale of Immovable Assets under the Securitisation and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 read with Proviso to Rule 8(6) & 9(1) of Security Interest (Enforcement) Rule, 2002

Notice is hereby given to the public in general and in particular to the Borrower(s) and Guarantor(s) that the below described immovable property mortgaged / charged to the Secured Creditor, the Physical possession of which has been taken by the Authorized Officer of Union Bank of India (secured creditor), will be sold on below mentioned dates "As is where is", "As is what is" and "Whatever there is" on the date mentioned below, for recovery of dues as mentioned hereunder to Union Bank of India from the below mentioned Borrower(s) & Guarantor(s). The Reserve Price and the Earnest Money Deposit are also mentioned hereunder:

S. No.	Name of Branch	Name & address of Borrower & Guarantor	Description of the Immovable property put for auction	Status of the possession Physical/ Constructive	Dues to be Recovered from Borrower/ Guarantor (Rs.)	Reserve Price (Rs.) EMD Bid Increment	Date and Time of Auction (with 10 min unlimited auto extensions)
1	Kirti Nagar (05732)	1. Ms. Bharti Shami (Borrower) 71A, SG Pocket , Jhilmil, Dilshad Garden, Delhi-110095 Also at: 127 D , 3rd floor, Pocket-I, Dilshad Garden, Delhi-110095	All that part and parcel of the property no. 127 D, 3rd floor, Pocket – I, Dilshad Garden, Delhi-110095 Bounded; On the North-east – open space/park, On the South-west – entrance/stairs, On the East-south – open space/road, On the West-north – other property	Physical	Rs. 60,39,389.68 as on 11-07-2025 (plus interest and Other Expenses thereon)	Rs. 90,00,000.00 from Rs. 9,00,000.00 Rs. 90,000.00	03.09.2026 from 12.00 PM to 05.00 PM (with 10 min unlimited auto extensions)

List of Encumbrances: NIL known to bank. However SA /319/2025 is pending before DRT-2, Delhi but there is no stay in the matter.
Last date of Submission of bid: On or before the commencement of e-Auction
For All Property Sr. No. 1 : Invariably, the first bid of the property/ies will be Reserve Price + one Increment.
This amount will be the minimum bid amount to participate in bidding process.
Authorized Officer - Ms. Ankita Rajput, 7757016816

For detailed terms and condition of the sale, please refer to the link provided in https://baanknet.com and https://www.unionbankofindia.bank.in/auction-property/viewauction-property.aspx. Further Bidder for Registration and Login and Bidding Rules visit https://baanknet.com only.

This may also be treated as STATUTORY 15 DAYS SALE NOTICE UNDER RULE 8(6) & Rule 9(1) OF SECURITY INTEREST (ENFORCEMENT) RULES 2002, to the borrower's and guarantor/s

Date: 13-08-2026
Place : New Delhi
Authorised Officer, Union Bank of India

US Ambassador calls West Bank settler siege act of terror

SAM METZ ■ Jerusalem

The US Ambassador to Israel condemned the actions of Jewish settlers who are besieging the home of an American Palestinian family in the Israeli-occupied West Bank.

US Ambassador Mike Huckabee called the siege a "horrific act of terror." Since Sunday, according to local officials and family members, settlers have gathered near the home in the village of Qusra and harassed those inside, defying efforts by the Israeli military to defuse the situation.



A group that has included up to dozens of men has thrown stones, attempted to bring down a stone

wall nearby, and prevented the occupants from leaving despite dwindling supplies. Speaking to The Associated Press by phone from his home in Ohio, the home's owner Lou Ridi said his 48-year-old brother and nephew, who have been holed up in the home to defend it, had been unable to leave the house and did not have access to food or water for several days.

On Thursday morning, the owner's brother Qusai Abu Rida said that he and his teenage son had been evacuated by Israel's military. It was unclear what

would happen to the property and at least one other that has been targeted.

Israeli troops intervened in recent days to try to restore order. The military said that overnight Thursday its troops had dismantled "two illegal outposts" on the outskirts of Qusra and a nearby village, and detained one Israeli.

It added that additional soldiers had surged to the area, which is about 16 kilometers (10 miles) of the Palestinian city of Nablus, to "carry out defensive missions and patrols." Journalists on the outskirts of Qusra said roads into the

village were closed. Israeli police did not immediately respond to questions about whether any Israeli civilians had been arrested.

Palestinians and the Israeli opposition accuse Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu's hardline government of turning a blind eye to attacks by settlers against Palestinians as clashes have surged in the last few years.

Huckabee's post on X was an unusually sharp rebuke from a US official, even as he defended the Israeli military's response.

Huckabee is a longtime ally of Israel's settler movement and in

the past has expressed support for Israeli control over the occupied West Bank while condemning settler violence. Home security footage from Thursday morning appeared to show a few settlers still hiding by a damaged stone wall near the house.

Ridi said that settlers have been harassing his home for months before the situation escalated in recent days, saying they had cut off the water and electricity to his house and thrown stones, causing damage to the property as well as at least one more house in the area. "We are prisoners in our

own house, hostages in our own house," he said.

Last month, a mosque in Qusra was set on fire in another apparent settler attack. That followed the killing of an Israeli settler, which triggered violence that left two Israeli soldiers and four Palestinian villagers dead.

Settlers have been building more outposts in an effort condemned by many in the international community as aimed at dismantling any remaining hopes of establishing a Palestinian state in the occupied West Bank. (AP)

Ex-Nepal PM Deuba returns after treatment

SHIRISH B PRADHAN ■ Kathmandu

Former prime minister Sher Bahadur Deuba returned to Nepal on Thursday after spending more than five months abroad for medical treatment following injuries sustained during the Gen Z protests last year.

Deuba and his wife, former foreign minister Arzu Rana Deuba, were seriously injured during violent protests on September 9, 2025, when anti-Government demonstrations led by the Gen Z movement swept across Nepal and resulted in the fall of the KP Sharma Oli Government. The couple travelled to Singapore in February for medical treatment. Deuba, who is also the former president of Nepali Congress (NC), reportedly stayed in Hong Kong for a brief period as well.

According to his party leaders, Deuba landed at Tribhuvan International Airport here in the afternoon after completing his medical treatment.

The whereabouts of Rana remain unclear. Deuba was received at the airport by senior NC leaders, including Purna Bahadur Khadka, Shashanka Koirala, Prakash Man Singh and Bimalendra Nidhi, among others. Hundreds of party activists from across the country gathered near the



airport to welcome the former prime minister, cheering as he arrived.

In an appeal issued after his arrival, Deuba said the mountains, green hills and vast plains of the Tarai had called him back home.

The former premier said he has returned not as a leader but as a lifelong citizen of the nation, ready to serve with humility, dedication, and love.

Deuba, 80, has served as Nepal's prime minister five times between 1995 and 2022 and is a veteran NC leader. He became party president in 2016 and was re-elected in 2021. During the Gen Z protest, Deuba was not holding any ministerial position. He was serving as a Member of Parliament and the party president. (PTI)



People observe a partial solar eclipse at Northala Fields in London

Houthi, Govt clashes flare in Yemen

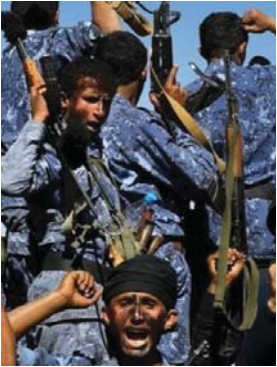
ASSOCIATED PRESS ■ Cairo

Clashes between Iran-backed Houthi rebels and Government forces in Yemen raged overnight on Thursday as renewed violence continues to spread and feed growing fears that the country's civil war could reignite and create a new front in the West Asia war.

At least one Government soldier was killed and another critically wounded in clashes between Houthi rebels and the military in the mountainous province of Taiz, Yemeni military officials said.

He fighting came as part of a spate of recent attacks by the Houthis on Government-held areas across the country. Dozens of government troops have been killed in attacks since last week, the Yemeni military said. Elsewhere, several tribal leaders in the central province of Marib said the Yemeni army's artillery targeted overnight Houthi movements.

The Houthis have been hitting Government-held areas with drones and missiles, saying they have been targeting military forces and warehouses. They have also been attacking oil facilities in neighbouring Saudi Arabia, which supports the Yemeni Government, and the kingdom's shipping in



the Red Sea. On Tuesday, they hit a commercial ship in the Bab el-Mandeb strait, killing six people. With the Strait of Hormuz effectively shut down by Iran, there has been a renewed focus on the Red Sea and Bab el-Mandeb strait at Yemen's southern tip, which is an alternate route for Saudi Arabia to ship its oil.

Three Pakistanis were among the dead in the ship attack, and Indonesia's Foreign Ministry said Thursday that one of its nationals was missing after the attack and two were wounded.

Iran And Oman Clean Oil Spills
Oil spills spreading off the coasts of Iran and Oman are raising concerns about environmental damage as oil shipments have come under fire in Iran's war with the US and Israel.

The Pioneer Classified

CHANGE OF NAME

I, Banojalata Mallick, Mother of -No.16118313Y SPR Ratikanta Mallick, R/o- Vill- Kotalghata, PO- Kushberia, P.S- Uluberia, Dist- Howrah, West Bengal- 711316, have changed my name from Banojalata Mallick to Banajalata Mallick, vide affidavit dated 13/08/2026 before Notary Public Delhi.

I, Girver Kanwar, Mother of -No.16021816A Hav Surendra Singh, R/o- Vill- Rooppura, Teh- Nawa, Dist- Nagaur, Rajasthan- 341508, have changed my name from Girver Kanwar to Giravar Kanwar, vide affidavit dated 13/08/2026 before Notary Public Delhi.

I, Neha Bai, D/o- JC- 472518X Sub Ajay Pal, R/o- Vill- Giglana, PO- Mehatawas, Dist- Alwar, Rajasthan- 301704, have changed my name from Neha Bai to Neha Kumari, vide affidavit dated 13/08/2026 before Notary Public Delhi.

I, Ghemender Singh, S/o- JC- 472532K Sub Sabal Singh Rathore, R/o- Vill & PO- Sankara, Dist- Jaisalmer, Rajasthan- 345026, have changed my name from Ghemender Singh to Ghemendra Singh, vide affidavit dated 13/08/2026 before Notary Public Delhi.

I, Shila, Mother of No.16020715A Hav Mayank Chaudhary, R/o- I C2 Chandanvan Phase 1 M PO- Head Post Office Mathura, Dist- Mathura, U.P- 281001, have changed my name from Shila to Sheela Devi, vide affidavit dated 13/08/2026 before Notary Public Delhi.

I, Nilendri Swain M/o No.15721752W L/NK Aloka Swain, R/o Vill- Jiroli, PO- Kirapalli, Tehsil- Bellaguntha, Dist-Ganjan, Odisha-761119 have changed my name from Nilendri Swain to Niladri Swain for all future purposes vide Public Notary Delhi affidavit dt 10-08-2026.

I, No.15455945K Sep Gali Guruswamy, R/o- Door No.1-162, Vill- Jeedipalli, Po- Ankampalli, Teh - Beluguppa, Dist- Anantpur, Andhra Pradesh- 515741 declare that Gali Ramdevi is my mother. In my service record her D.O.B is 04/08/1975 whereas correct DOB is 01/01/1975 which may be amended accordingly.

I, Patel Amrut Lal, Father of- No.14667867X Hav Patel Sanjay Kumar Amrut Lal, R/o- Vill+PO- Chadasana, Teh- Mansa, Dist- Gandhinagar, Gujarat- 382810, have changed my name from Patel Amrut Lal to Amrutbhai Patel, vide affidavit dated 13/08/2026 before Notary Public Delhi.

I, Patel Usha Ben, Mother of- No.14667867X Hav Patel Sanjay Kumar Amrut Lal, R/o- Vill+PO- Chadasana, Teh- Mansa, Dist- Gandhinagar, Gujarat- 382810, have changed my name from Patel Usha Ben to Ecchaben Patel, vide affidavit dated 13/08/2026 before Notary Public Delhi.

I, JC-471868X Sub Maj Inderjeet Singh R/o- Vill- Hoshiyarpur Sec 51, Dist- Gautam Buddh Nagar, U.P- 201301, have changed my name from Inderjeet Singh to Indrajeet Singh, vide affidavit dated 13/08/2026 before Notary Public Delhi.

I, Anjoo Yadav, W/o- No.15190595H Nk Ajay Kumar, R/o- Vill- Bhurjani, Post- Fatehpur Jasoda, Dist- Kannauj, Uttar Pradesh- 209733, have changed my name from Anjoo Yadav to Anjoo Devi, vide affidavit dated 13/08/2026 before Notary Public Delhi.

I, Gulshana Begum, W/o. Mohammad Irshad, R/o. A-2, 337C/21, Gali No. 7, Batla House, Jamia Nagar, Okhla, New Delhi- 110025, hereby declare that my name has been incorrectly mentioned in my daughter Laiba Irshad's Class 10th marksheet as Gulshana instead of my correct name, Gulshana Begum.

I, Shashi Kiran W/o Sushil Kumar Garg R/o A- 901, Nirala Eden Park, Indirapuram, Ghaziabad have changed my name to Shashi Garg after marriage for all future purposes.

I, Sabha Chand Pandey, S/o Rajdev Pandey, R/o 262, Chanderlok Colony, Street No.1 Shahdara, Delhi- 110093, hereby declare that Sabha Pandey and Sabha Chand Pandey refer to the same person. Henceforth, I shall be known as Sabha Chand Pandey for all official and future purposes.

GOVERNMENT OF ASSAM | অসম চৰকাৰ
OFFICE OF THE CHIEF ENGINEER | মুখ্য অভিযন্তাৰ কাৰ্যালয়:
PWD BUILDING | লোক নিৰ্মাণ (গৃহ) বিভাগ:
ASSAM:: GUWAHATI - 3 | অসম:: গুৱাহাটী- ৩

No. নিবিদা প্রসংগ নং:-CE/TB-II(Bldg.)/109/2024/15

PRESS NOTICE (RE-TENDER)

নিবিদা আহ্বান কৰা জাননী (পুনৰ নিবিদা)

The Chief Engineer, PWD (Building), Assam, Chandmari, Guwahati-03 on behalf of the Governor of Assam, invites fresh bid for the work detailed in the table below, from eligible Firm/Contractor of reputed having experience in similar nature of work. Details of bid may be seen at e-procurement portal i.e. www.assamtenders.gov.in

The bidders must be enrolled with e-tendering web portal www.assamtenders.gov.in

মুখ্য অভিযন্তা, লোক নিৰ্মাণ (গৃহ) বিভাগ অসম, চান্দমাৰী, গুৱাহাটী-০৩ এ অসম চৰকাৰৰ বাজাপালৰ হৈ, তলত উল্লেখ কৰা কামৰ বাবে অভিজ্ঞতা থকা প্ৰতিস্থিত ফাৰ্ম/ঠিকাদাৰৰ নতুনকৈ নিবিদা আহ্বান কৰিছে। নিবিদাৰ সবিশেষ তথ্য ই-প্ৰক্ৰিয়াৰে পঢ়িবলৈ www.assamtenders.gov.in ত চাব পাৰিব।

নিবিদাকাৰীসকলে ই-টেন্ডাৰ ৱেব পৰ্টেল www.assamtenders.gov.in ব জৰিয়তে পঞ্জীয়ন কৰিব লাগিব।

Sl. No. ক্ৰ. নং	Name of work কামৰ নাম	Approx. Value of work (in Rs) কামৰ আনুমানিক মূল্য (টকাত)	Bid Security নিবিদা পত্ৰ সুৰক্ষা	Bid Processing Fee নিবিদা প্ৰক্ৰিয়াকৰণ মূল্য (টকাত)	Completion period সম্পূৰ্ণ কৰাৰ সময়সীমা
1.	Proposed Judicial Qtr. Grade II (G+2) for SDJM Court Complex, Titabar, Dist. Jorhat	4,44,88,798.00 ৪,৪৪,৮৮,৭৯৮.০০	2 % for General category or 1 % for Reserved category on value of work	Rs.8,900/- ৮,৯০০.০০ টকা	15 (Fifteen) Months ১৫ (পোন্ধৰ) মাহ
১.	প্ৰস্তাৱিত ন্যায়িক আবাস গ্ৰেড-II (G+২) এছজিজেএম আদালত কমপ্লেক্স, তিতাবৰ, জিলা-যোৰহাট		সাধাৰণ শ্ৰেণীৰ বাবে কামৰ মূল্যৰ ২% আৰু সংৰক্ষিত শ্ৰেণীৰ বাবে ১%		

Note টোকা:
(i) Value of work may vary according to the detail NIT. কামৰ মূল্য বিতংভাৱে আহ্বান কৰা নিবিদা জাননী অনুযায়ী পৰিৱৰ্তন হ'ব পাৰে।
(ii) All terms and conditions will be as per the Bidding Documents. সকলো চৰ্ত আৰু নিয়মাবলী নিবিদা নথিপত্ৰ অনুযায়ী হ'ব।
(iii) The Press Notice will be a part of the Bidding Documents. নিবিদা আহ্বান কৰা জাননী নিবিদা নথিপত্ৰৰ অংশ হ'ব

Chief Engineer, PWD (Building)
Assam, Chandmari, Guwahati-3.
মুখ্য অভিযন্তা, লোক নিৰ্মাণ (গৃহ) বিভাগ, অসম, চান্দমাৰী, গুৱাহাটী-৩।

DIPRC/PIO/114/13-Aug-26

যমুনা এক্সপ্ৰেসৱে অট্টোচগিক বিকাশ প্ৰাধিকৰণ
প্রথম তল, কোম্পাৰ্শিয়ল কোম্পলেক্স, পী-2, সৈকত-অগমেগা-1, গ্ৰেট নৌএছ, জনপদ গৌতমবুদ্ধ নগৰ, 201308 (উ.প্ৰ.)
Toll Free No. 18001808296 ৱেবসাইট: www.yamunaexpresswayauthority.com

পত্ৰাংক : ৱাই.ই.এ./মূলেখ/978/2026

দিনাংক : 12.08.2026

সার্বজনিক সূচনা

যমুনা এক্সপ্ৰেসৱে অট্টোচগিক বিকাশ প্ৰাধিকৰণ দ্বাৰা সৈকত – 07 গ্ৰাম মুদৰহ সৈকত – 08 এফ গ্ৰাম ঘনসিয়া অন্তৰ্গত আনে ৱালী ভূমি কা সুনিয়োজিত বিকাশ হেঁতু সম্বন্ধিত কৃষকোঁ দ্বাৰা দী গয়ী সহমতি কী দর ৱু০ 3808.00 / – প্ৰতি বৰ্গমী০ সে প্ৰাধিকৰণ দ্বাৰা শাসনাধৰে সংখ্যা– 314/77–3–163এম, দিনাংক 23.02.2016 মঁ তথ প্ৰক্ৰিয়ানুসাৰ নিম্নানুসাৰ ক্ৰয় ক্ৰিয়া জানা প্ৰস্তাৱিত হৈ–

ক্রম. সঁ.	সৈকত / গ্ৰাম কা নাম	খাতা সংখ্যা	খসরা সংখ্যা	খসরে কুল ক্ষেত্ৰফল (হে০ মে)	খাতেদান কা নাম ব পতা	তহসীল সে প্ৰাপ্ত ৰিপোর্ট কে আধাৰ পৰ কাশতকাৰ কা হিৰুসা	কাশতকাৰ হেঁতু ক্ষেত্ৰফল (হে০ মে)
1.	মুদৰহ সৈকত 7	38	197	1.0770	বীৰৱতী পত্নী ৰূগৱত নি০ গ্ৰাম চকবীৰমপুৰ	মে সে	0.0843
2.	মুদৰহ সৈকত 7	83	383	0.8380	ৰাধেলাল পুত্ৰ মহাসিহ নি০ বীৰমপুৰ	মে সে	0.0211
3.	মুদৰহ সৈকত 7	83	383	0.8380	পংকজ পুত্ৰ ৰামফল নি০ হাল নি০ 111/7 হটস ব্লক শক্তি নগৰ মলকা গঁজ উত্তৰী দিল্লী	মে সে	0.0211
4.	মুদৰহ সৈকত 7	246	296	1.0270	ৰামশ্ৰী পত্নী চন্দ্ৰপাল সিহ ব মন্সু০ ৱানী পত্নী যশপাল ব যোগেন্দ্ৰ পুত্ৰ চন্দ্ৰপাল সিহ নি০ মুদৰহ	মে সে	0.0422
5.	মুদৰহ সৈকত 7	51	612	2.4960	আজাদ কুমাৰ পুত্ৰ প্ৰমু নি. বিৰৌড়ী চক্ৰসৈনপুৰ জিলা গৌতমবুদ্ধনগৰ	মে সে	0.1469
6.	মুদৰহ সৈকত 7	51	612	2.4960	হৰীৰাম পুত্ৰ প্ৰমু সিহ নি. বিৰৌড়ী চক্ৰসৈনপুৰ জিলা গৌতমবুদ্ধনগৰ	মে সে	0.0611
7.	মুদৰহ সৈকত 7	395	238	0.6960	ত্ৰিলোকচন্দ্ৰ শৰ্মা পুত্ৰ মূৰলীধৰ নি০ গ্ৰাম মুদৰহ	মে সে	0.1160
8.	মুদৰহ সৈকত 7	395	238	0.6960	ৰাজেন্দ্ৰ শৰ্মা পুত্ৰ মূৰলীধৰ নি০ গ্ৰাম মুদৰহ	মে সে	0.1160
9.	মুদৰহ সৈকত 7	395	223 238	0.6030 0.6960	সুৰাশ চন্দ্ৰ পুত্ৰ সুখপাল নি০ গ্ৰাম মুদৰহ	মে সে	0.3015 0.3480
10.	মুদৰহ সৈকত 7	395	238	0.6960	অমপ্ৰকাশ শৰ্মা পুত্ৰ মূৰলীধৰ নি০ গ্ৰাম মুদৰহ	মে সে	0.1160
11.	মুদৰহ সৈকত 7	257 256 255	247 244 249	1.6470 0.8220 2.0300	ৰালা দেৱী পত্নী ৰমেশ নি. গংগলা শাহপুৰ	মে সে	0.1373 0.0685 0.2532
12.	মুদৰহ সৈকত 7	91	576	1.5900	অক্ষয় পৰাৰ পুত্ৰ ৰাজকুমাৰ সিহ নি০ গোটকা মেৰড উত্তৰ প্ৰদেশ	মে সে	0.0843
13.	মুদৰহ সৈকত 7	299 103 103	155 157 167	1.1380 0.5310 0.2400	লায়কৰাম পুত্ৰ ৰূগৱান সহায় নি. মুদৰহ	মে সে	0.2076 0.1062 0.0480
			230 274d 491	2.4050 0.0630 0.5230			0.4810 0.0126 0.1046
14.	মুদৰহ সৈকত 7	256 257 255	244 247 249	0.8220 1.6470 2.0300	অনিল কুমাৰ পুত্ৰ পন্না লাল ব দেৱৱতী পত্নী পন্না লাল নি০ গংগলা শাহপুৰ	মে সে	0.0685 0.1373 0.1692
15.	মুদৰহ সৈকত 7	211	243	2.5640	জয়কুমাৰ ৰাঘৱ পুত্ৰ শ্যাম ৰাঘৱ নি০ পালম সাউথ দিল্লী	মে সে	0.1265
16.	মুদৰহ সৈকত 7	253	229	0.7440	ৰামঅৱতাৰ পুত্ৰ মহেন্দ্ৰপাল শৰ্মা নি০ মুদৰহ	মে সে	0.2480
17.	মুদৰহ সৈকত 7	184	598	1.2330	গজেন্দ্ৰ পুত্ৰ চত্ৰ নি০ ঘনৌৰী কলা তহ০ ব জিলা গৌতমবুদ্ধনগৰ	মে সে	0.0844
18.	মুদৰহ সৈকত 7	304 26	413 421	1.6170 0.4810	প্ৰমোদ কুমাৰ পুত্ৰ মূলপাল সিহ নি. মুদৰহ	মে সে	0.0223 0.0400
19.	মুদৰহ সৈকত 7	184	598	1.2330	অনুপ পুত্ৰ উম্মেদ নি০ মুদৰহ	মে সে	0.0698
20.	মুদৰহ সৈকত 7	184	598	1.2330	কশ্চিদা পুত্ৰ খেমা নি০ মুদৰহ	মে সে	0.3926
21.	মুদৰহ সৈকত 7	304	413	1.6170	অৰুণ কুমাৰ পুত্ৰ শ্ৰীপাল সিহ নি০ মুদৰহ	মে সে	0.0843
22.	মুদৰহ সৈকত 7	304	413	1.6170	সাগৰ না০ ৰা০ আয়ু 15 বৰ্ষ পুত্ৰ প্ৰবীন সং০ মাতা স্বয় কমলেশ নি মুদৰহ	মে সে	0.0843
23.	মুদৰহ সৈকত 7	234	621	0.9530	ব্ৰজেশ কুমাৰ পুত্ৰ ধূৰী উৰ্ফ ধূৰে সিহ নি০ মুদৰহ	মে সে	0.0794
24.	মুদৰহ সৈকত 7	234	621	0.9530	ৰাজেশ পুত্ৰ ধূৰী উৰ্ফ ধূৰে সিহ নি মুদৰহ	মে সে	0.0794
25.	মুদৰহ সৈকত 7	234	621	0.9530	নাৰায়ণী পত্নী ধূৰী উৰ্ফ ধূৰে সিহ নি০ মুদৰহ	মে সে	0.0794
26.	মুদৰহ সৈকত 7	234	621	0.9530	মুকেশ কুমাৰ পুত্ৰ ধূৰী উৰ্ফ ধূৰে সিহ নি০ মুদৰহ	মে সে	0.0794
27.	মুদৰহ সৈকত 7	370	420	1.1450	ৰাধা পত্নী মূৰাৰী সিহ নি মুদৰহ	মে সে	0.1982
28.	ঘনসিয়া সৈকত 8 এফ	33	72f০	0.4740	শ্ৰীমতী অংজলী অগ্ৰৱাল পত্নী ৰাজকুমাৰ অগ্ৰৱাল নি০ মী০ কোট আজাদ চৌক কাজীৰাড়া জেৱৰ	মে সে	0.0948
29.	ঘনসিয়া সৈকত 8 এফ	33	72f০	0.4740	ৰজনী ৰঁসল পত্নী ৰামঅৱতাৰ নি০ জেৱৰ	মে সে	0.0948
30.	ঘনসিয়া সৈকত 8 এফ	62	61	0.3610	গুঁজন পত্নী হৰেন্দ্ৰ কুমাৰ নি০ বীৰমপুৰ	মে সে	0.0902
31.	ঘনসিয়া সৈকত 8 এফ	109 74	64e 65	0.4250 0.6460	সূৰজমুখী পত্নী অঁকাৰ নি০ চকবীৰমপুৰ	মে সে	0.2125 0.1310
32.	ঘনসিয়া সৈকত 8 এফ	43	72e	2.5910	ৰমা পত্নী সনী ব ৰংজনা পত্নী ৰৱিন্দ্ৰ নি০ অতৰপুৰ জিলা হাপুড	মে সে	0.0843
33.	ঘনসিয়া সৈকত 8 এফ	43	72e	2.5910	জগৱতী পত্নী ৰোহতাশ নি০ অতৰপুৰ জিলা হাপুড	মে সে	0.0843
34.	ঘনসিয়া সৈকত 8 এফ	124	36	1.6700	আদেশ কুমাৰ পুত্ৰ বীৰসিহ নি০ সাকীপুৰ	মে সে	0.1044
35.	ঘনসিয়া সৈকত 8 এফ	124	36	1.6700	সাবিত্ৰী দেৱী পত্নী বীৰসিহ নি০ সাকীপুৰ	মে সে	0.1044
36.	ঘনসিয়া সৈকত 8 এফ	124	36	1.6700	ৰিতেশ কুমাৰ পুত্ৰ বীৰসিহ নি০ সাকীপুৰ	মে সে	0.1044
37.	ঘনসিয়া সৈকত 8 এফ	124	36	1.6700	পংকজ কুমাৰ পুত্ৰ বীৰসিহ নি সাকীপুৰ	মে সে	0.1043

উপৰোক্ত ভূমি ক্ৰয় ক্ৰিয়ে জানে মঁ যদি কিসী ৱ্যক্তি কো কোই আপতি হৈ তাে হৱ লিখিত ৰূপ মঁ 15 দিন কে অন্ধৰ অধোহস্তাধৰী কো অপনী আপতি প্ৰস্তুত কৰ সকতা হৈ।

ডিপ্টি কলেক্টৰ
যমুনা এক্সপ্ৰেসৱে প্ৰাধিকৰণ

যমুনা এক্সপ্ৰেসৱে অট্টোচগিক বিকাশ প্ৰাধিকৰণ কে অধিসূচনিত ক্ষেত্ৰ মঁ প্ৰাধিকৰণ দ্বাৰা স্বীকৃত মাষ্টৰ প্লান কে অতিৰিক্ত প্লানিং/হাৱসিং/কালৌনী ৱা কিসী ৱী প্ৰকাৰ কা অন্ধ নিৰ্মাণ পূৰী তহৰ সে অৱধ হৈ। সামান্যজন ৱ্ৰশ প্ৰকাৰ কী ৱৰীদকৰোছ সে পূৰ্ণতা: সযেত ৱহে তথা কালৌনাডজ কে গ্ৰামক বিজ্ঞাপনৌ সে ৱৰে। অধিক জানকাৰী কে লি়ে প্ৰাধিকৰণ কী ৱেবসাইট www.yamunaexpresswayauthority.com দেখে।

PROSPECT



ONGC Chairman & CEO Arun Kumar called on Assam CM Himanta Biswa Sarma in Guwahati and committed ₹25 crore towards Assam floods (₹5 crore to the Chief Minister's Relief Fund and ₹20 crore to help rebuild over 700 flood-affected schools, with nearly ₹3 lakh per school)

Fire incident at ONGC installation in Kalol Field brought under control

A minor fire incident was reported this morning at one of ONGC's installations in the Kalol Field. ONGC's Fire and Emergency Response teams responded immediately and successfully extinguished the fire.

No injury or harm to any personnel has been reported. The situation is fully under control, and normal production operations have been completely restored. ONGC places the highest priority on the safety of its personnel, assets and neighbouring communities. The Corporation remains committed to maintaining robust safety standards and emergency-response preparedness across all its operational locations.



Delhi Transco appeals to people not to fly kites near high tension lines



With kite flying expected to increase during the monsoon season and around Independence Day, Delhi Transco appeals to the public to fly kites in open spaces such as parks and playgrounds and should not use metal-coated manjha for their safety and smooth transmission of power because their minor carelessness can lead to major power failure, blackout, electrocution or even death.

The extra high voltage transmission lines are the corridor to transmit bulk power feeding the larger areas. Whenever there is a tripping due to entangling of kites, it takes considerable time to locate and remove the kite from the line; therefore, it may result in an outage for a long time. During the last few years many trippings running in the few hundreds have occurred in the Delhi Power System, which includes both transmission and distribution, due to kite flying on 15th August.

UPSIDA CEO inspects Ex-LIDA, Sarojini Nagar industrial areas

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
Lucknow

Under the leadership of the Chief Minister of Uttar Pradesh, Yogi Adityanath, the Uttar Pradesh State Industrial Development Authority (UPSIDA) is continuously working towards strengthening and expanding industrial infrastructure across the State. The Authority is making a significant contribution towards achieving the vision of transforming Uttar Pradesh into a 1 Trillion Economy.

In this direction, the Chief Executive Officer (CEO), UPSIDA, conducted a field inspection of the Ex-LIDA Industrial Area and Sarojini Nagar Industrial Area on Thursday. During the inspection, detailed information regarding the infrastructure facilities, industrial activities and other related arrangements available in



the areas was obtained from the concerned officers and representatives of the industrial community.

During the visit to the Ex-LIDA Industrial Area, the CEO conducted a detailed on-site assessment of various facilities and directed the concerned officers to ensure that basic infrastructure facilities are strengthened, properly maintained and systematically managed in accordance with the requirements of industrial units.

Particular emphasis was

meeting, detailed discussions were held on various issues related to the industrial area, infrastructure facilities, maintenance works and matters raised by the entrepreneurs.

The CEO stated that UPSIDA is continuously working towards promoting industrial investment in Uttar Pradesh and creating a conducive environment for industries. Effective management of basic infrastructure facilities, time-bound resolution of issues faced by entrepreneurs, and regular engagement with the industrial community are among the key priorities of the Authority.

The concerned officers were directed to examine the issues and suggestions received from industrial units in accordance with the applicable rules and ensure their time-bound and effective resolution.

Ramraj Cotton launches PANCHHAATM

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi

Ramraj Cotton has launched PANCHHAATM, a new handloom offering that reimagines the traditional Santhali weave of Mayurbhanj, Odisha, as a contemporary Dhori. Through Panchaa, the brand continues its effort to bring India's lesser-known weaving traditions into the spotlight, creating renewed recognition and livelihood opportunities for the tribal women weavers who keep the craft alive.

Traditionally woven as sarees by women of the Santhali tribal community, this distinctive weave has gradually faded from prominence over the decades due to declining patronage, changing lifestyles and limited market opportunities. Recognising both its artistic value and its potential for contemporary relevance, KR Nagarajan, Founder & Chairman, Ramraj Cotton, has now reimagined the Santhali weave in the form of the Dhori through Panchaa. Panchaa retains the traditional character of the weave while giving it a new,



wider relevance. Each piece is handwoven in 100 per cent cotton with an off-white base and azo-free dyes, combining a plain weave with an extra-weft technique — a reflection of the skill of the weavers who continue to practise this generations-old tradition.

Commenting on the launch, The Culturepreneur, KR Nagarajan, Founder & Chairman, Ramraj Cotton, said, "The Santhali weave of Mayurbhanj is one such treasure. We believed it deserved a wider audience without losing its authenticity. With Panchaa, we have reimagined this traditional weave as a dhoti, creating a new avenue for the craft while preserving the skill and identity behind it. Our hope is that this initiative encourages greater appreciation for the weave and strengthens the livelihoods of the women weavers who have kept this tradition alive."

124th SLBC meeting held in New Delhi

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi

The 124th meeting of the State Level Bankers' Committee (SLBC), Delhi, was held on Wednesday at Hyatt Regency, New Delhi. The meeting was chaired by Principal Secretary Santosh Vaidya and M Parmasivam, Executive Director, Punjab National Bank.

The meeting was attended by several senior officials and banking-sector dignitaries, including Sarada Prasan Mohanty, Regional Director, Reserve Bank of India, New Delhi; Nazuk Kumar, Managing Director, Delhi State Industrial and Infrastructure Development Corporation (DSIIDC); Rajneesh Gupta, Joint Commissioner of Delhi Police; MM Ayeppan, Joint Secretary, Department of Financial Services; and Nabin Roy, Chief General Manager, NABARD.

The proceedings were coordinated by Debarchan Sahoo, General Manager and SLBC Convenor. Senior officials from various banks,



Delhi State Heads and other distinguished representatives also participated in the meeting. During the meeting, Santosh D Vaidya has reviewed the performance of banks under PM Suryaagar and various social security schemes.

MM Ayyappan has advised the bank to improve TAT in lending. Sarada Prasan Mohanty, Regional Director, RBI, has said that with coordination with SLBC, we will monitor Msme growth of banking sector. Nazuk Kumar briefed the participating banks on the Delhi State DCGS scheme where 95 per cent cgtime covers is available. She encouraged banks to actively extend finance to eligible beneficiaries under these schemes and emphasised the role of credit support in promoting entrepreneurship and economic development in Delhi.



Union Home Minister Amit Shah and his wife Sonal Shah on Thursday unfurled the Tiranga at his Delhi residence under the Har Ghar Tiranga campaign

CM Sukhu reviews progress of Himachal Niketan building

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi

Chief Minister Thakur Sukhvinder Singh Sukhu on Thursday visited Himachal Niketan at Dwarka, New Delhi, and reviewed the progress of the building, which is nearing completion. He took detailed stock of the ongoing construction and directed the concerned officers to complete the remaining finishing works at the earliest so that the facility could be dedicated to the people of Himachal Pradesh at the earliest.

The Chief Minister said that Himachal Niketan would provide comfortable and quality accommodation facilities to people from the state visiting the national capital, particularly for medical treatment and educational purposes.

He said that the facility would offer almost four-star category amenities and serve as an important support system for



Himachalis visiting Delhi. Built at an estimated cost of around ₹190 crore, Himachal Niketan will have 107 rooms along with a restaurant, a banquet hall, two multipurpose halls, a meeting hall and student dormitories. The facility will also include adequate parking space, landscaped gardens, EV charging stations and other modern amenities. The Chief Minister said that the project was of significant importance for the people of Himachal and directed the officials to ensure that all remaining works were completed within the stipulated timeframe while maintaining the required quality standards.

DAILY SUDOKU

			9					
3	1		8			2		4
		6	5	1			8	
							4	3
1			2			6		5
8	5							
	7				8	3	2	
2		3			5		1	9
				1				

DIFFICULTY RATING: ★★☆☆☆

HOW TO SOLVE IT

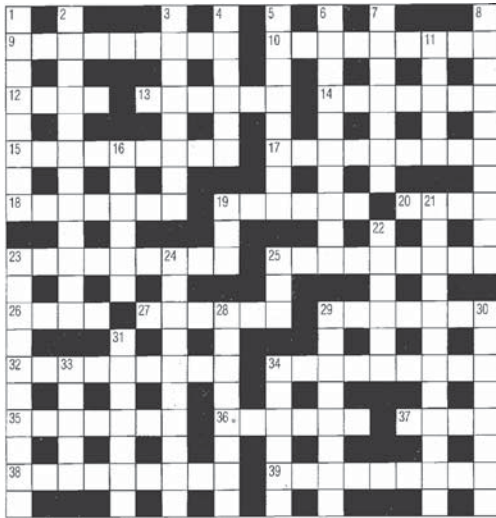
Sudoku is a logic puzzle where you fill a 9×9 grid so that numbers 1 to 9 appear once in every row, column, and 3×3 box, using elimination and logical deduction—no maths involved.



SOLUTION (13.8.26)

7	2	3	5	8	1	4	6	9
5	9	6	4	2	7	8	3	1
4	8	1	9	3	6	5	2	7
3	7	2	1	9	4	6	8	5
1	5	4	8	6	2	9	7	3
9	6	8	7	5	3	2	1	4
2	3	9	6	1	5	7	4	8
6	4	5	3	7	8	1	9	2
8	1	7	2	4	9	3	5	6

DOUBLE CROSSWORD
FRIDAY | AUGUST 14, 2026



ACROSS

- 9 Near in the clear - until tomorrow (9)
- 10 Figure the man hurt got caught in a skiing disaster (9)
- 12 Bear up when there's a suspension (4)
- 13 Cooking food outside for the animals (6)
- 14 First to give one's approval to (7)
- 15 At home, I have the fireplace to blacken
- 17 Trifle with a pretty woman toting a gun
- 18 A little band for the hair (7)
- 19 "Hates Crooks," a hard cover (6)
- 20 Ring the gentleman from the jeweller's
- 23 Not bothered when one went off on one's own (4,5)
- 25 Furnished, or provided, with a job (9)

DOWN

- 1 Take into account, when you mull over
- 2 The cost of one's keep? (9,3)
- 3 Ranting foolishly about nothing, having a lot to learn (8)
- 4 Are out to attack (6)
- 5 Not so wonderful as to stop you in your tracks? (8)
- 6 Not telling the truth about burying the hatchet? (6,2,2)
- 7 Said to put out on the streets - they're very cruel (7)
- 8 Properly repaired at last? That's rich!
- 11 The companion is off colour - a cold (5)
- 16 A merry lawbreaker in an Irish holiday

26 Drop off at the building (4)

- 27 Firm though, without it, the least bit wobbly (6)
- 29 Read the notes (7)
- 32 They've done wrong by accepting the last tenders (9)
- 34 On a happy note's re-packing the bag (9)
- 35 Go off when people annoy, or ruffle (7)
- 36 A type of stress (6)
- 37 Tries - and it works (4)
- 38 The one with the awkward stance on the outside is Chinese (9)
- 39 He fights, but not for money (9)
- resort (6)
- 19 Am in disgrace with the lady (3)
- 21 Decode, say? (3,4,5)
- 22 Shout at us "Break!" (6)
- 23 Humiliation that wearing a mask was responsible for? (4,2,4)
- 24 Not inclined to be honest (2,3,5)
- 25 Fear you and I will get ahead of (3)
- 28 It's for the baby fish I catch (8)
- 29 The foreigners are, alas, in trouble after it (8)
- 30 Are they needed for a saucy play? (8)
- 31 Continually egg the girl and fellow to
- 33 As a father, have to look disapproving
- 34 Look at the big end - open up (6)

BHEL enters into strategic tie-up with Hystar AS, Norway for PEM electrolyser systems



PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi

Bharat Heavy Electricals Limited (BHEL) and Hystar AS, Norway, have entered into a strategic tie-up which shall enable phased indigenisation and local manufacturing of PEM electrolyser systems for green hydrogen projects in India.

The agreement was signed by Y Srinivas Rao, Executive Director (Heavy Power Equipment Plant, Hyderabad), and Sutripto De, General Manager & Head (New & Renewable Energy Business), on behalf of BHEL, and by Fredrik Mowill, CEO (Hystar), on behalf of Hystar AS Norway; in the presence of Arvinn Eikeland Gadgil, Chargé d'Affaires, Royal Norwegian Embassy in New Delhi, and Bani Varma, Director (Industrial Systems & Products, BHEL), SM Ramanathan, Director (Engineering, Research & Development, BHEL), and other senior officials.

Notably, BHEL has already entered into a strategic tie-up with thyssenkrupp nucera India Private Limited for alkaline electrolyser systems

earlier this year. This collaboration with Hystar for PEM electrolyser systems further strengthens BHEL's position as one of the few Indian players capable of offering both alkaline and PEM electrolyser solutions to serve the country's emerging green hydrogen market. Moreover, the collaboration will also strengthen BHEL's project execution capabilities for green hydrogen projects in India.

BHEL is one of India's leading engineering and manufacturing companies, with decades of experience across power, transmission, renewables, oil & gas, transportation, defence and aerospace sectors. The company has played a key role in building India's industrial infrastructure and is now leveraging its engineering, manufacturing and project execution capabilities to address emerging clean energy areas, including green hydrogen.

This agreement marks a significant step in enhancing BHEL's contribution to the National Green Hydrogen Mission and the Government of India's Make in India initiative.

Haryana Govt approves Bill for setting up Masters Union University in Gurugram

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi

The Haryana Cabinet, which met under the chairmanship of Chief Minister Nayab Singh Saini on Thursday, approved the proposal to move The Haryana Private Universities (Amendment) Bill, 2026, for setting up Masters Union University in Gurugram by amending the Haryana Private Universities Act, 2006.

The proposed university will be established by Shanti Foundation Trust, Gurugram, a charitable, non-political, non-profit and non-sectarian trust working in the field of education. The proposal is aimed at expanding higher education opportunities for the youth of the state and strengthening the participation of the private sector in expanding the capacity and quality of higher education in Haryana.

The university is proposed to be established on approximately 5.14 acres of contiguous land. A building with a constructed area of approximately 1,07,358 square feet is already available at the site, including around 96,600



square feet of instructional area, 5,400 square feet of administrative area, 5,000 square feet of amenities area and 358 square feet of circulation area. The sponsoring trust has the property on lease for a period of 30 years. The proposal has been examined by the relevant committees constituted under the Haryana Private Universities Act, 2006. The Academic Committee and Finance Committee examined the proposal, while the committee constituted under the chairmanship of the Chairperson, Haryana State Higher Education Council, recommended the issuance of the Letter of Intent subject to stipulated conditions.

PUNJAB STATE POWER CORPORATION LTD.
(Regd. Office: PSEB Head Office, The Mall Patiala-147001)
Corporate Identity Number U40109PB2010SGC033813 Website- www.pspcl.in
Mobile No. 96461-55525

E-Tender Enq. No. 753/P-3/EMPW-13411 Dated 13-08-2026
Dy. Chief Engineer/ Headquarter (Procurement Cell-3) GGSSTP, Roopnagar
Invites E-Tender ID No. 2026_POWER_173558_1 for Replacement of HP Bypass valves ARS-100/ E325 of 210 MW 'KWU' designs unit at GGSSTP Roopnagar.
For detailed NIT & Tender Specification please refer to <http://eproc.punjab.gov.in> from dated 13-08-2026/ 05:00 PM onwards.
Note:- Corrigendum & addendum, if any will be published online at <http://eproc.punjab.gov.in>

1079/12/2026-27/14249 Dated CHD :- 13/08/2026

RTP-79/26



India ponder three left-arm spinners for Galle Test

G UNNIKRISHNAN ■ Galle

Bowling coach Morne Morkel on Thursday indicated that India could field three left-arm spinners in the upcoming first Test against Sri Lanka here, as Kuldeep Yadav, Manav Suthar and Ravindra Jadeja offer unmatched variety and wicket-taking skills. Kuldeep bowls magic and mystique through his left-arm wrist spin; Jadeja's pinpoint accuracy can trouble even the best, but Suthar is a throwback to the days of loopy classical left-arm spin. "Kuldeep is there, and he's the attacking sort of bowler, and for us, his experience and class can't be looked past. So yeah, I think for us they're all different in their way," Morkel told the media here on Thursday. "So one (Suthar) turns a bit more, one (Jadeja) is slightly more accurate, and I don't think it's a (three left-arm spinners) massive concern for us. "It's just how Gill is going to use those guys at certain times. But yeah, I mean in terms of skill they've got the skill to get the

20 wickets for us," he added. Morkel said India's spin line-up gave them a very attacking option, also considering the nature of the Galle pitch that may favour spin as the match progresses. "Traditionally, also if you look at the venue, how it stacks and how it's been played up, that's sort of the way (three spinners) to go, I think. The way we go with our spin bowling attack, or spinners, is a very attacking option. "But looking at the surface, you know, to me, it looks like a good surface, and I think as the Test goes on, you know, something will start to happen. "So, we've prepared for all that can come our way, as it is more about the mental challenge in playing these conditions, batting time, bowling those spells and getting the ball



in the right areas," he detailed. Apart from the seasoned Siraj, India will have to take either Gurnoor Brar or Prasidh Krishna, who have limited Test experience, as support pacers. Morkel said whoever gets the final nod - Prasidh or Brar - will be equal to the task. "I think it's exciting. They've played a lot of cricket back home where it's also tough bowling conditions, and I think coming here the biggest challenge will be the heat and humidity. "The Kookaburra ball...once it gets softer, you know how we can stack up overs together with intensity and create that pressure. So, I'm quite excited about what I have seen over the last week or so, how these guys can stand up." But beyond all these calculations, Morkel said, it is all about how the bowlers can sustain the intensity for a longer period. (PTI)



Kings of Galle: Jayasuriya-Mendis twister awaits Indian batters



G UNNIKRISHNAN ■ Galle

At times, cricketers make a particular stadium their favourite opera centre - churning out awe-inspiring performances one after another. Mahela Jayawardene and Muttiah Muralitharan wrecked oppositions at Sinhalese Sports Club; Jacques Kallis' numbers at Newlands are beyond belief, while Stuart Broad at Lord's was an unstoppable force. Now, two Sri Lankan spinners - Prabath Jayasuriya and Ramesh Mendis - have made Galle International Cricket Stadium here their personal abattoir, running roughshod over rival batters. Together, they have amassed 145 wickets at this venue - left-arm spinner Jayasuriya has plucked 81 wickets in a mere 11 Tests while off-spinner Mendis has taken 64 wickets in 12 matches here. Former Sri Lankan cricketer Farvez Maharroof explained this unusual success rate. "Prabath Jaysuriya is going to be the main weapon. We have nicknamed him the 'King of Galle' because of the number of wickets he has taken there. "He knows how to bowl with the

wind, and the wind is going to be a major factor in Galle because of the drift the spinners can generate," said Maharroof. It might not be particularly encouraging news for Indian batters, who have of late struggled against quality spinners. New Zealand left-arm spinners Ajaz Patel and Mitchell Santner had destroyed India in their own backyard, and later off-spinner Simon Harmer of South Africa repeated the feat. Now, the Indian batters will have to face a quality left-arm and off-spin combination in the same match. Former Sri Lankan spinner Upul Chandana offered a word of caution. "Jayasuriya has quickly become Sri Lanka's top spinner. He largely bowls in the conventional way; you know, he hardly gives any freedom to the batsmen. If the pitch has a different bounce on it, then his accuracy will be very helpful," says Chandana. The former spinner offered the example of Jayasuriya, a discovery of former Lankan skipper Dimuth Karunaratne, getting rid of Pakistan batsman Babar Azam quite regularly. (PTI)

Himanta felicitates CWG silver medallist Lovlina



TONY DAS ■ Guwahati

Chief Minister Himanta Biswa Sarma on Friday felicitated internationally acclaimed boxer Lovlina Borgohain at Lok Sewa Bhawan in Dispur for her outstanding achievement of winning the silver medal in the 75 kg boxing category at the recently concluded Commonwealth Games in Glasgow. In recognition of her exceptional achievement at the Commonwealth Games, the Chief Minister presented Lovlina Borgohain with a cheque of Rs 30 lakh on behalf of the State Government. Felicitating Lovlina, Chief Minister Sarma lauded her remarkable sporting prowess and unwavering determination displayed on the international sporting forum. Describing Lovlina's achievement as a matter of immense pride for the sporting fraternity of Assam and the country, the Chief Minister said that her consis-

tent success has continued to inspire the youth of the State to pursue excellence in sports. The Chief Minister said that Lovlina, who has achieved success at the international level through hard work, perseverance and self-confidence, is a role model for young sportspersons. He expressed hope that Lovlina would continue to deliver outstanding performances in the boxing ring in the days ahead and bring further laurels to the country. As a memento of the Commonwealth Games, Lovlina Borgohain presented two jerseys of the Indian team to the Chief Minister. Minister for Sports and Youth Welfare, Biswajit Daimari, Additional Chief Secretary to the Chief Minister, KK Dwivedi, and Special Secretary, Sports Department, KJ Hilali, were present at the felicitation programme.

Bodoland win 6-0 but miss out on Durand knockouts

TONY DAS ■ Guwahati

Former India international Halicharan Narzary delivered an extraordinary individual performance with four goals and two assists, but it proved insufficient to keep Bodoland FC's Durand Cup campaign alive. Despite crushing local rivals Karbi Anglong Morning Star FC 6-0 in their final Group F fixture at the Indira Gandhi Athletic Stadium, Bodoland FC failed to qualify for the quarter-finals of the 135th IndianOil Durand Cup. Despite finishing second in Group F with six points from three matches, Bodoland FC missed out on a quarter-final berth as one of the best second-placed teams. East Bengal FC and Jamshedpur FC also finished with six points, but advanced courtesy of supe-



rior goal differences. Meanwhile, Karbi Anglong Morning Star FC ended their campaign without a single point for the second consecutive season. Karbi Anglong almost sprang a surprise within 20 seconds of kick-off when Joseph Olaleye broke through, but his shot went straight into the arms of Bodoland keeper Birkhang Daimary.

Bodoland broke the deadlock when Sidharth Khichi was fouled inside the box by Karbi Anglong keeper A. Muhammed Murshid. Narzary stepped up to the spot and calmly converted to give his side the lead. Karbi Anglong were handed a lifeline shortly after when defender Shubham Sarangi brought down Olaleye in the Bodoland penalty area. Junior Onguene Nkengue took the penalty, but Daimary produced a fine save before reacting swiftly to deny Paogoumang Singson from the rebound. Narzary doubled Bodoland's lead just before the hydration break, latching onto a well-timed pass from Robinson Rendon to evade Singson and curl a low effort into the bottom corner. Daimary was called into action again before

half-time, pulling off a series of impressive saves against Taison Singh, Olaleye, and Manglienboi Neihisai to preserve the two-goal cushion into the break. Bodoland extended their lead six minutes into the second half through substitute Kaushik Daimari, who turned deftly past two defenders on the edge of the box before unleashing a precise left-footed strike. The Bodoland skipper completed his hat-trick in the 84th minute, controlling Daimari's cross at the far post before lifting the ball neatly over the advancing goalkeeper. Five minutes later, Narzary turned provider, swinging in a low cross from the right flank for substitute Ggwmsar Gayary to slot home from close range.

STATE BANK OF INDIA

E-AUCTION SALE NOTICE

BRANCH OFFICE: HOME LOAN CENTRE, A1/24, JANAKPURI, NEW DELHI-110058

NOTICE FOR E-AUCTION SALE ON 31.08.2026 FOR MOVABLE PROPERTY

E-Auction Sale Notice for Sale of Movable Assets under the Securitization and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 read with proviso to Rule 8(6) of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002. Notice is hereby given to the public in general and in particular to the Borrower(s) and Guarantor(s) that the below described movable property hypothecated /charged to the Secured Creditor, the physical possession of which has been taken by the Authorized Officer State Bank of India, the Secured Creditor, will be sold on "As is Where is", As is What is" and Whatever there is" on 31.08.2026, for recovery of bank due to the secured creditor as under:-

Interested bidder may deposit Pre-Bid EMD with BAANKNET before the close of e-Auction. Credit of Pre-Bid EMD shall be given to the bidder only after receipt of payment in BAANKNET's Bank Account and up-dation of such information in the e-auction website. This may take some time as per banking process and hence bidders, in their own interest, are advised to submit the pre-bid EMD amount well in advance to avoid any last minute problem.

Date / Time of E-Auction on 31.08.2026 for 8 Hours from 10:00 AM to 06:00 PM with unlimited extn. of 10 minute each.

S. No.	Name of the Borrower(s)/ Guarantor(s)	Outstanding Dues for Recovery of which Property/ies is/are being Sold	Vehicle Description	Reserve Price (Rs.) (below which property could not be sold) Earnest Money (EMD) 10% of the Reserve Price Bid Increment Amount	Name of the Authorised Officer
1.	SH. ASHISH KUMAR CHADHA Car Loan A/c. No. 42189203638 257, Adarsh Apartment Sector 3, Dwarka, New Delhi-110075	Rs.6,28,341.00 as on 16.11.2025 plus future Interest and other Charges etc. thereon	Make & Model: BALENO DELTA AGS Vehicle No.: DL9CBC5592 Engine No.: K12NP4307377 Chassis No.: MBHWH31SPG516321 Mfg. Date: 07/2023 Fuel: Petrol / CNG	₹ 4,21,000.00 ₹ 42,100.00 ₹ 5,000.00 *GST as applicable	Mr. Madan Kumar (Chief Manager) HLC, A1/24, Janakpuri, New Delhi-110058. Tel-011-79681631 Mr. Hemant Mobile: 9034545090
2.	SH. SHOBHIT DUA Car Loan A/c. No. 43946736285 474, 3rd Floor, Sainik Vihar, Pitampura, New Delhi-110034.	Rs.12,32,983.00 as on 25.12.2025 plus future Interest and other Charges etc. thereon	Make & Model: SYROS G1 0T 7 DC THK PLUS Vehicle No.: DL10CZ4859 Engine No.: G3LCSM362270 Chassis No.: MZBB281VSN013640 Mfg. Date: 02/2025 Fuel: Petrol / Ethanol	₹ 8,41,000.00 ₹ 84,100.00 ₹ 5,000.00 *GST as applicable	Mr. Madan Kumar (Chief Manager) HLC, A1/24, Janakpuri, New Delhi-110058. Tel-011-79681631 Mr. Hemant Mobile: 9034545090
3.	MR. MD. NAZIM SAFI Car Loan A/c. No. 41536153861 1144 Block D, DDA Flat, Pocket 3, Bindapur, New Delhi-110059.	Rs.5,51,333.00 as on 08.10.2025 plus future Interest and other Charges etc. thereon	Make & Model: KIGER RXT PETROL MT 1.0 Vehicle No.: DL10CU7028 Engine No.: B4DA417E197659 Chassis No.: MEEHB000N9072818 Mfg. Date: 12/2022 Fuel: Petrol	₹ 2,50,000.00 ₹ 25,000.00 ₹ 5,000.00 *GST as applicable	Mr. Madan Kumar (Chief Manager) HLC, A1/24, Janakpuri, New Delhi-110058. Tel-011-79681631 Mr. Sandeep Mobile: 9315052074

Last Date of EMD Deposit on or before 31.08.2026 upto 9:00 A.M.
Account/ Wallet in which EMD to be remitted : Bidder's own wallet Registered with BAANKNET on its e-auction site: <https://baanknet.com/eauction-psb/eproc-listing> by means of NEFT/RTGS. EMD of Reserve Price to be transferred by bidders by means of challan generated on his/her/bidder account maintained with BAANKNET on its e-auction site: <https://baanknet.com/eauction-psb/eproc-listing> by means of NEFT from his/her/bidder bank. For any assistance, please call BAANKNET HELPDESK: +91 8291220220, support.BAANKNET@psballiance.com and/or Authorized Officer.

TERMS AND CONDITIONS OF THE E-AUCTION ARE AS UNDER:
(1) E-Auction is being held on "As is where is", "as is what is basis" and "whatever there is basis" and will be conducted "On Line". The auction will be conducted through the Bank's approved service provider BAANKNET at their web portal: <https://baanknet.com/eauction-psb/eproc-listing>
(2) Bank shall reserve the right to cancel/postpone the auction.
(3) The Vehicle are available for inspection during banking hours on 28.08.2026 from 11:00 AM to 17:00 Hrs. , at Shriram Mall, Faridabad. Contact Person for Sl. No. 1 and Sl. No.2 - Mr. Hemant Kumar Mobile: 9034545090, M/s. Suraj Legal Solutions Pvt. Ltd. (Resolution Agent) and Contact Person for Sl. No.3 - Mr. Sandeep Mobile: 9315052074, Moneycare (Resolution Agent).
(4) Successful bidder to pay GST as applicable on the successful bid amount, viz sale value.
(5) To the best of knowledge and information of the Authorized Officer there is no encumbrance on the property/ies. However the intending bidder should make their own independent inquiries regarding the encumbrances, title of the property/ies put on auction and claims/tights/dues/affecting the property prior to submitting their bid. The e-Auction Advertisement does not constitute and will not be deemed to constitute any commitment or any representation of the Bank. The property is being sold with all the existing and future encumbrances whether known or unknown to the bank. The Authorized Officer shall not be responsible in any way for any third party claims/rights/ dues.
(6) The Earnest Money Deposit (EMD) of the successful bidder shall be retained towards part sale consideration and the EMD of the unsuccessful bidders shall be refunded. The Earnest Money Deposit shall not bear any interest. The successful bidder shall have to deposit 25% of the sale price, immediately on acceptance of bid price by the Authorized Officer and the balance of the sale price on or before 15th day of the sale. Default in deposit of amount by the successful bidder would entail forfeiture of the whole money already deposited and property shall be put to the e-auction and the defaulting bidder shall have no claim/right in respect of property / amount.
(7) For detailed terms and conditions of the sale please refer to the link at the Bank's Service Provider's web portal: <https://baanknet.com/eauction-psb/eproc-listing> & e-auction website: <https://BAANKNET.com>

Place: New Delhi Date: 13.08.2026 Authorized Officer, State Bank of India, Home Loan Centre, Janakpuri, New Delhi

ReNew Solar Energy (Jharkhand Three) Private Limited				
CIN No. : U40300DL2016PTC301311				
Regd Office : 138, Anand Chambers-II, Bikaji Cama Place, New Delhi-110066				
Corporate Office : ReNew.Hub, Commercial Block-1, Zone 6, Golf Course Road				
DLF City Phase-V, Gurugram, 122009, Haryana, Phone No. : 124 489 6670/80				
Statement of Unaudited Financial Results for the quarter ended 30 June 2026				
(Amounts in INR Millions, except share and per share data, unless otherwise stated)				
Particulars	Quarter ended 30 June 2026 (Unaudited)	Quarter ended 31 March 2026 (Refer Note 7)	Quarter ended 30 June 2025 (Unaudited)	Year ended 31 March 2026 (Audited)
Total Income from Operations	648	489	522	1,921
Net (Loss) Profit for the year (before Tax, Exceptional and/or Extraordinary items)	295	87	142	368
Net (Loss) Profit for the year before tax (after Exceptional and/or Extraordinary items)	295	87	142	368
Net (Loss) Profit for the year after tax (after Exceptional and/or Extraordinary items)	234	67	84	261
Total Comprehensive Income for the year (Comprising Profit / (Loss) for the period (after tax) and Other Comprehensive Income (after tax))	234	112	84	201
Paid up Equity Share Capital	170	170	170	170
Reserves (excluding Revaluation Reserve)	1,968	1,733	1,546	1,733
Securities premium	997	997	997	997
Net worth	2,137	1,903	1,716	1,903
Paid up Debt Capital / Outstanding Debt	9,205	9,268	9,770	9,267
Debt Equity Ratio	2.99	3.26	3.67	3.26
Earnings Per Share (of Rs. 10/- each) (for continuing and discontinued operations)				
1. Basic :	13.80	3.96	4.93	15.34
2. Diluted :	6.80	1.93	2.40	7.96
Debt-Equity Ratio	1.37	2	2	2
Debt Service Coverage Ratio*	1.21	0.83	1.27	0.82
Interest Service Coverage Ratio*	2.99	1.61	2.04	1.84
Current ratio*	2.31	1.99	1.20	1.99
Long Term Debt to Working Capital*	3.86	4.24	12.63	4.24
Current Liability Ratio*	0.11	0.12	0.16	0.12
Total Debts to Total Assets Ratio*	0.64	0.65	0.63	0.65
Debtors Turnover Ratio*	2.66	4.78	2.52	9.08
Inventory Turnover Ratio*	NA	NA	NA	NA
Operating margin (%)	67%	60%	67%	57%
Net profit margin (%)	48%	15%	17%	15%
Not audited				
Additional disclosures pursuant to Regulations 52(4), 54(3) and 63(2) of Securities and Exchange Board of India (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015 (as amended):				
Notes :				
1. Ratios have been computed as follows : - Earning per share = Profit after tax / Weighted average number of equity shares - Debt Equity Ratio* = Debt (Total Debt payable to lender) / Equity (Equity share capital, share premium, loan from Related party) - Interest Service Coverage Ratio* = Profit before interest, tax and depreciation / Total Interest Expense. - Current Ratio* = Current Assets/ Current Liabilities - Outstanding redeemable preference shares (Quantity & Value) = The company has not issued any preference share, hence, not applicable - Long Term Debt to Working Capital*= Non- Current borrowing including current maturities of Non-current borrowings/ (Current Assets - Current Liabilities excluding current maturities of Non-Current borrowings) - Bad debts to Accounts Receivable ratio*= Bad debts / Average Trade receivables and Average unbilled Revenue - Current Liability Ratio*= Current Liabilities/ Total Liabilities - Total Debts to Total Assets* = Total outstanding debts/ Total Assets - Debtors turnover= Revenue from operation/ Average trade receivables and Average unbilled Revenue - Inventory Turnover- Not applicable - Operating margin(%)= (Profit before tax + Finance costs - Other income) / Revenue from operations - Debt Service Coverage Ratio* = (PAT (excluding non-cash adjustments, if any)+ Depreciation + Interest / Interest, Guarantee Fees, other financing costs payable under Debt service and Project Documents)) / (Interest + Principal Repayment only (schedule repayment/guarantee fee)). - Net profit Margin= Net Profit after tax /Revenue from operations				
2. The above is an extract of the detailed format of quarterly financial results filed with the Stock Exchange(s) under regulation 52(4) 54(3) and 63(2) of the Listing Regulations. The full format of the quarterly financial results is available on the website of National Stock Exchange of India Limited and the listed entity URL(s) (https://www.nseindia.com)).				
3. For the other line items referred in Regulation 52(4) 54(3) and 63(2) of the SEBI (LODR) Regulations, 2015, the pertinent disclosures have been made to the National Stock Exchange of India Limited and can be accessed on the URLs (https://www.nseindia.com)).				
4. The statement has been prepared in accordance with recognition and measurement principles laid down in accordance with the Indian Accounting Standard as prescribed under Section 133 of the Companies Act, 2013 ("the Act") read with Rule 3 of the Companies (Indian Accounting Standards) Rules, 2015 and relevant rules issued thereunder and other recognized accounting practices and policies.				
5. The company is in the business of renewable power generation and other ancillary activities. There are no separate reportable segments (business and/or geographical) in accordance with the requirements of IND AS - 108 "Operating Segments" and hence there are no additional disclosures to be provided other than those already provided in the financial statements.				
6. The financial results for the quarter ended June 30, 2026 have been approved by the Board of Directors in their meeting held on 13 August 2026.				
7. The figures for the quarter ended 31 March 2026 are the balancing figures between the audited figures for the full financial year ended 31 March 2026 and the unaudited year-to-date figures up to the end of the third quarter of the respective financial year.				
8. Care Ratings has assigned long term issuer rating and rating for the outstanding non-convertible debentures of the Company to "CARE A+ " with stable outlook.				
9. The figures of the quarter ended 30 June 2025 are the unaudited and reviewed management internal reporting figures. However, management has exercised necessary due diligence to ensure that the financial results for the periods provide true and fair view of the company's affairs.				
10. Previous period figures have been re-grouped / re-classified wherever necessary, to conform to current period's classification.				
For and on behalf of the ReNew Solar Energy (Jharkhand Three) Private Limited Sd/- Place : Gurugram Date : 13 August, 2026 Deepak Gupta Director, DIN : 01812112				

BRIEFLY

India emerge overall champions in CWG fencing



India have emerged as the overall champions at the Commonwealth Fencing Championship, returning with 35 medals from the event held in Lagos, Nigeria. Indian fencers won 13 gold, eight silver and 14 bronze medals across the U-23 and senior competitions. The senior Indian fencers claimed five gold medals in six events on the fourth day of the competition, securing honours in men's sabre, women's sabre, men's epee, women's epee and women's foil, as well as a silver in men's foil. The performance also helped India win the Wilkinson Sword Trophy. (PTI)

Ladakh LG opens Leh's first 24x7 ice hockey rink



In a major boost to winter sports infrastructure in Ladakh, Lieutenant Governor Vinai Kumar Saxena on Thursday inaugurated the Union Territory's first international-level artificial ice hockey rink at NDS Stadium, describing the facility as a major investment in the future of Ladakh's young sportspersons. Built at a cost of approximately ₹42 crore, the state-of-the-art rink is equipped with a 24x7 chilling facility, enabling ice hockey players to train throughout the year, irrespective of the natural weather conditions. The Lieutenant Governor termed the facility a landmark investment in Ladakh's youth and expressed confidence that it would help transform the UT into one of India and the world's leading winter sports hubs. He said the project aligns with Prime Minister Narendra Modi's vision of making India a global sporting powerhouse and expanding access to quality sports infrastructure across the country. (PTI)

FIFA chief Infantino receives support from six Arab federations



STEVE DOUGLAS ■ Zurich

The heads of six Arab soccer federations expressed their "full support" and "confidence" in Gianni Infantino on Thursday as the embattled FIFA president fights to keep his job after his failed World Cup private investment plan. The backing came from 2030 World Cup co-host Morocco, Qatar, Egypt, Mauritania, Lebanon and Sudan, with four of the signatories being FIFA council members. "We, the undersigned leaders of our respective football associations, express our full support for Mr Gianni Infantino, President of FIFA, and reaffirm our confidence in his leadership and continued commitment to the development of football worldwide," the statement read. "We deeply appreciate Infantino's sustained efforts to advance football globally, expand opportunities across all regions and strengthen the game's role in bringing people and communities together." The statement said the signatories "look forward to continuing our close cooperation with him towards a stronger and more prosperous future for world football, expanding opportunities and further enhancing Arab football's contribution to the global game."

TTFI urges ministry to revoke suspension

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA ■ New Delhi

The Table Tennis Federation of India (TTFI) on Thursday flagged the implications of the Sports Ministry's decision to suspend the national body for the sport, stressing that its autonomy under the IOC's Olympic Charter must be respected and its governance kept free from third-party interference. It also urged the Ministry to keep its August 12 order in abeyance and reconsider the matter afresh. The ministry on Wednesday withdrew recognition of the TTFI and asked the Indian Olympic Association (IOA) to form an ad-hoc committee to run the sport, citing governance lapses. The ministry said the TTFI's failure to hold elections on time was among the reasons for the suspension, following an "unsatisfactory response" to a show-cause notice issued earlier this year.

Gukesh crumbling under pressure, needs to shut out noise: Nakamura

AMIT KUMAR DAS ■ Paris

World champion D Gukesh is crumbling under the weight of expectations and needs to shut out the noise to regain his form ahead of his title defence, said American Grandmaster Hikaru Nakamura, who also revealed that the 2028 Chess Olympiad could potentially be his last tournament featuring "true classical" chess. Gukesh has faced a slump since his historic 2024 World Championship win, dropping down in ratings after finishing last at both Norway Chess and a recent event in Chennai, alongside low finishes at the Tata Steel Chess and Prague Masters.

"I don't know what Gukesh can do differently. I know what he should have done differently, which is to basically be willing to take draws in a lot of games instead of trying to play for the win," Nakamura said to a PTI query on Wednesday. "But obviously, I'm not Indian. So, I don't necessarily understand the culture, all the pressure that he's facing. But I get the general sense



that there's a lot of pressure whether it's external, whether it's internal. I think he's crumbling because of it. "I think if he can kind of just, like, block it all out, forget that he's world champion. You know, this is obviously quotable. But sort of forget that he's never going to be Magnus Carlsen. I'm quite confident his rating will go back up." Gukesh's classical FIDE rating dropped to 2703 in the August 2026 list. "I don't know if it'll go to 2,800. But I mean, he'll definitely get to, like, 2,740 at least if he kind of just puts a couple of things out of his mind. But obviously, it's very hard," Nakamura continued. (PTI)



"TTFI respectfully seeks the Ministry's kind consideration of the implications that any external or interim administrative arrangement may have in this regard, including the principles of autonomy recognised under Rules 27 and 28 of the Olympic Charter," TTFI said in a statement written by its President Meghna Ahlawat. "The Olympic Charter and the Statutes of the International Table Tennis Federation (ITTF) recognise and expressly protect the autonomy of National Sports Federations and require their governance and administration to remain free from any third-party interference," it added. The statement, while expressing

its high regard for the ministry, said the federation was duly registered under the Societies Act and that its governance and administration as an autonomous National Sports Federation were governed by its Constitution and the applicable principles of sporting autonomy. "TTFI is an autonomous society duly registered under the Societies

Registration Act, 1860, and is governed by its Constitution and General Body. The Federation holds the Ministry in the highest regard and recognises its role. "At the same time, TTFI respectfully submits that the governance and administration of an autonomous National Sports Federation are guided by its Constitution and the applicable principles of sporting autonomy and good governance," the statement said. TTFI chief Ahlawat, who took charge in December 2022, is the wife of former Haryana Deputy Chief Minister Dushyant Chautala, son of former TTFI president Ajay Singh Chautala. The federation has been embroiled in turmoil for several months. In January, it suspended its secretary general and former player Kamlesh Mehta over alleged financial irregularities. Mehta challenged the suspension in the Delhi High Court, which later quashed it.

Pranavi and Diksha make modest starts in Swiss Ladies Open

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA ■ Holzhausem (Switzerland)

India's Pranavi Urs and Diksha Dagar were off to a modest start in the opening round of the Swiss Ladies Open even as a Spanish duo took the early lead in the event. The Indian duo, both backed by Hero, carded 1-under 70 and even par 71 after early tee offs. Pranavi was tied 16th, while Diksha was T-32, though more than half the field was yet to finish the first round. Tvesa Malik, also supported by Hero, is making her first LET start since May in Mauritius. She finished 1-over with two birdies, one bogey and a double bogey and lying tied 65th. Tvesa was a runner-up in 2024, when she lost to Alice Hewson, who is aiming for a third win at the event. Spain's Luna

Sobron Galmes and Amaia Latorre were tied for the top spot with cards of 6-under 65 each, while another Spaniard Blanca Fernandez (66) was third. England's Hewson who is aiming for an unprecedented three-peat of victories in the competition had just started the round but was 1-over after two holes. The 28-year-old earned her second Ladies European Tour (LET) win at this event in 2024 defeating India's Tvesa Malik in a playoff before defending her title in style with a dominant five-shot victory last time out. Swedish legend Annika Sorenstam was the last player to three-peat on the LET when she won the HP Open (later renamed the Scandinavian TPC hosted by Annika) in 2004, 2005 and 2006 on home soil. As for form, Hewson has enjoyed a fine month on home turf making the cut at the co-sanctioned ISPS HANDA Women's Scottish Open and AIG Women's Open before finishing T6 at last week's PIF London Championship.

Indian women's hockey team has real chance of a podium finish in WC: Savita

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA ■ New Delhi

Seasoned goalkeeper Savita Punia believes India's FIH Nations Cup triumph has given the women's hockey team the confidence and belief to challenge the world's best and finish on the podium at the upcoming World Cup. India head into the showpiece event on the back of their Nations Cup title, where they beat a competitive field to claim their first major international gold in a long time. "Winning the FIH Nations Cup was a big achievement because all the top teams were there. It was a competitive tournament, and coming out on top gave us a huge boost and winning a gold medal after a long time has lifted the team's morale and belief," Savita told JioStar. The veteran feels India's performances against top sides in the FIH Pro League have also shown that the team is capable of competing with the best. "In recent years, during the FIH Pro League, we have played close matches against top sides like Argentina, Netherlands, and Germany. Those games showed us that we can match the best teams in the world," she said. "I can confidently say about this Indian women's hockey team that while all the teams are world-class, there is no team we



cannot compete with. We have the skill, the fitness, and the mindset to challenge anyone on our day." India will open their World Cup campaign against China on August 16 before taking on South Africa and England in Pool D. Savita, however, is wary of the challenges ahead and said India would need to remain focused on their own game rather than being distracted by the quality of the opposition. "We are going into the Women's Hockey World Cup with a lot of confidence, but our main focus is on our own game. Every team in the World Cup is strong, and there are no easy matches," she said.

Jamal Hossain takes two-shot lead as India open reduced to 54 holes

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA ■ Kolkata

Jamal Hossain carded a seven-under 63 to take a two-shot lead following the completion of the rain-delayed second round of the Coal India Open at Tollygunge Club in Kolkata on Thursday. The 41-year-old Bangladeshi golfer (65-63), a six-time winner on the DP World PGTI, moved to 12-under 128 after an eventful round featuring seven birdies, an eagle and two bogeys. Hossain began his second round three shots behind first-round leader Om Prakash Chouhan and was tied fifth when heavy rain forced the suspension of play on Wednesday. He returned on Thursday to complete his remaining holes when he moved clear of the field. The tournament has been reduced to 54 holes following the weather disruptions. The third and final round will be played on Friday with a shotgun start. Delhi's Kshitij Naveed Kaul (64-66), who held the clubhouse lead overnight, moved to second place at 10-under 130. Chandigarh's Akshay Sharma (66-



65) and Ajeetesh Sandhu (63-68) shared third place at nine-under 131. Former Asian Tour winner Sandhu endured multiple weather interruptions before completing a two-under 68 on Thursday. Current DP World PGTI Rankings leader Saptak Talwar (67-65), first-round leader and 2023 rankings champion Om Prakash Chouhan (62-70), and University of South Florida graduate Shubham Jaglan (67-65) shared fifth place at eight-under 132.

India pulls out of ASEAN Cup to prioritise friendly match against Brazil

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA ■ New Delhi

India have withdrawn from the inaugural FIFA ASEAN Cup, opting to prioritise their high-profile international friendly against five-time world champions Brazil in October, All India Football Federation (AIFF) deputy secretary general M Satyanarayanan said on Thursday. India's withdrawal from the upcoming tournament also means they will miss the opportunity to face some of Southeast Asia's leading sides in a FIFA-sanctioned competition. "We have pulled out of the FIFA ASEAN Cup since we can't play both Brazil and FIFA ASEAN Cup," Satyanarayanan told PTI.



The inaugural tournament was conceived as a new international competition for teams from the ASEAN region, with India invited as one of the non-ASEAN participants. India had initially accepted FIFA's invitation to participate in the new tournament and were subsequently drawn in Division 1 Group A alongside Indonesia, Malaysia and Singapore. The competition is scheduled to be played during the September 21-October 6 FIFA international window. However, India's commitment to play Brazil on October 3 at Kolkata's Salt Lake Stadium created a scheduling clash. The AIFF had earlier explored the possibility of fielding a separate or

developmental squad in the ASEAN Cup, but has now opted to withdraw altogether and use the international window for friendlies. The match against Brazil was officially announced last month. Meanwhile, reports on Thursday suggested that India are exploring friendlies against teams that featured at the 2026 FIFA World Cup, with Cabo Verde and Iran among the sides being discussed. However, those fixtures have not yet been officially confirmed by the AIFF. The AIFF's decision marks a significant change from its plans earlier this year, when it had accepted FIFA's invitation and signed the participation agreement.